Bright Moon High Proudly Presents

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/36477733.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra), all your favorites right here in one place

Additional Tags:
Friends to Lovers, Enemies to Lovers, Musical References, I know I'm so sorry, Alternate Universe - High School, Slice of Life

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by somebodysmuse

Summary

When Perfuma asks Bow to audition for their high school's production of Cinderella, Glimmer is not at all surprised when he's cast as the lead. What she doesn't expect is being cast as Cinderella alongside him, and she's certainly surprised when she realizes that she might have more-than-friendship feelings for her best friend. Backstage, Adora is certain that Catra, her ex-best friend and recent recruit on the tech crew, is up to something sinister. Laughter, tears, and lots of music ensue as the four navigate new feelings and new experiences as opening night approaches.

(TLDR: Glimbow High School AU, featuring a school musical.)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Chapter 1

"Seamus Hawkins isn't auditioning for the school musical."

Glimmer looked up from her phone and at Perfuma, who was standing above her and her two closest friends on the front steps of Bright Moon High.

"Who's Seamus Hawkins?" Adora asked.

"The tall senior, he's captain of the lacrosse team?" Bow explained.

"He's still in love with Mermista even though they broke up right before Prom last year-"

"Oh, you mean Sea Hawk!" Adora realized aloud. "Wait, he's passing up a chance to sing?"

"Is he okay?" Bow asked. "Is he sick?"

"He said that if we were doing our musical in the Spring like we usually do, he would be able to, but it's right in the middle of lacrosse season and because tech week is going to fall right in the middle of the last two weeks of rehearsal for the opera house's performance of *The Magic Flute*, even though I'm doing both

shows, too.“ She sighed and sat down beside Bow. “But now we don’t have a leading man.”

“I don’t know if you’ve noticed this, Perfuma, but there aren’t a whole lot of people auditioning to begin with,” Glimmer said. “The sign-up sheet has been up for two days, and only like, fifteen people are signed up.”

“Why aren’t people auditioning?” Adora asked.

“Because they’re putting on *Cinderella*,” Glimmer explained. “No one’s favorite Rodgers and Hammerstein show. We ran a poll over what the student body wanted to see in The Bright Moon Gazette, and almost no one one chose it.”

“I like *Cinderella*,” Perfuma said. “People have no respect for the classics. Everyone wanted to be in *Footloose* last year, but once we try to do something from the Golden Age-“

“Does this have something to do with the fact that you, our Resident Ingenue, would play Cinderella perfectly?” Glimmer asked. She knew, after seeing or acting in two years worth of school musicals, that Perfuma, with her soaring soprano voice, would undoubtably be cast in the titular role.

“I’m not playing Cinderella,” She said.

"Why not? Isn't she kind of like, the part you were born to play?" Adora asked.

"I talked to Netossa and Spinnerella already, and since I'm playing Pamina at the opera house-"

Glimmer's phone vibrated in her lap- Adora had sent a text to the group chat she shared with Glimmer and Bow.

ADORA: I don't know what Pamina is and I'm afraid to ask

Glimmer subtly texted her back.

GLIMMER: Soprano ingenue in *The Magic Flute*. It's an opera

Adora squeezed Glimmer's hand, silently thanking her.

"And since *The Magic Flute's* tech week is going to fall during show week of *Cinderella*, playing both Cinderella and Pamina would be too much for me," Perfuma finished explaining. Glimmer looked at Bow, who had been listening attentively the entire time she had been talking. Her heart swelled with fondness for her friend- he really was the sweetest.

"So let me get this straight- you don't have a leading lady or a leading man?"

"Well, Mermista could play Cinderella, in theory- I'm not too worried about that." Perfuma said, though her tone told them that

Mermista was not her first choice, and the three knew that Cinderella wasn't Mermista's first choice, either. "But we need a Prince Christopher."

"I don't know how-" Bow looked up at Perfuma, who was staring at him with wide, shining hazel eyes. "What's that look for?"

"We need gentlemen, Bow," She said, lacing her arm through his. Glimmer pulled her hand out of Adora's and set down her phone, turning her full attention to the other two.

"Perfuma-"

"Don't be like that," She said. "You love music-"

"I love my violin," Bow said, tapping his violin case. "I'm not a singer, not like Sea Hawk is, and the closest I've been to ever being in a musical is playing in the orchestra pit-"

"You're a better singer than you give yourself credit for," Perfuma informed him. "We might have to bolster your falsetto a bit-"

"What's wrong with my falsetto?"

"Nothing that can't be fixed," She said brightly. "I refuse to believe that Melody's baby brother wouldn't take Bright Moon High's

school musical by storm.”

Bow considered this- his second-to-youngest older sister, Melody, had played the leading roles in every Bright Moon High musical through all four years of high school, to say nothing of all the countless community theatre and opera house shows she had acted in since she was seven. He vividly remembered both of his dads crying at the end of Into the Woods.

But still, he wasn’t the singer that Melody was.

“Please audition, Bow. There are so few people that we aren't even holding callbacks. You would really be doing everyone a favor.”

“I think you’d be great,” Adora added from across the table. “Also, who else can they cast? Kyle?”

“Don’t you dare,” Perfuma very nearly snapped. Adora and Glimmer both giggled.

“I’ll think about it,” Bow said. Perfuma frowned.

“What can I do to convince you?” She asked.

“I said I’ll think about it,” Bow reminded her.

“I’ll audition, too.” Glimmer said, breaking her silence.

Bow turned to Glimmer. A single, bubblegum-colored curl had escaped her claw clip and was hanging in her face.

“Really?” Perfuma asked.

“I thought you said that Cinderella was nobody’s favorite-“

“I know,” Glimmer interrupted Adora. “But if we need more people, then we need more people. And I like musicals.”

Truth be told, Glimmer had only been in three musicals in her life and had only had named roles (though Bow would argue that Townsperson Number 1 was indeed a name) in two of them.

But who was she to disrespect the classics?

“That’s wonderful, Glimmer,” Perfuma said before pointedly looking at Bow, who sighed.

“I’ll go sign up for an audition time,” He conceded, standing.

“Wonderful!” Perfuma squealed, clapping her hands. “You’re going to be excellent, I just know it. Both of you.”

“I’ll go with you,” Glimmer told Bow, standing and slinging her backpack over her shoulder. They waved to Adora and Perfuma before disappearing inside the school.

“Huh,” Perfuma said thoughtfully. “I should have approached that differently.”

“Why?” Adora asked.

“If I had gotten Glimmer to audition first, it would have been easier to get Bow to do the same.” Perfuma explained. “They’re inseparable.”

“I know,” Adora said fondly. Outside of Bow being on the school's archery team and in the orchestra while Glimmer wrote for the school newspaper, she couldn't think of a single thing that they did without one another. “So there are really no other boys auditioning?”

“Not really,” Perfuma said. The bell rang, beckoning them inside.

“So does that mean that Bow is playing Prince Charming-“

“Prince Christopher-“

“Sorry, Christopher- by default?”

“Maybe,” Perfuma said. “Nothing is set in stone. But between the two of us, I can’t see any other options.”

“Hm,” Adora said. “So what does that mean for Glimmer, role-wise?”

“I don’t know,” Perfuma said, tucking a long, blonde curl behind her ear. “We’ll have to wait until after auditions.”

Adora waved goodbye to Perfuma and made her way to her first class. As she passed the choir corridor, she saw the audition sign-up sheet on the doorway. She could make out the names of her two dearest friends, written side-by-side in glittery purple and red ink. Even their names were inseparable.

oOo

“Mom, do you mind if I print something?” Glimmer asked, holding her laptop and standing in the doorway of her mother’s home

office.

"Not at all, dear," Angella said, not looking up from her computer screen. Glimmer was used to her mom spending most of her time in her home office, working on whatever case she was handling at any given time. Angella worked at the law firm she owned with her sister-in-law- it was through Glimmer's Aunt Casta that her parents had met.

Their cat, a sliver tabby named Miette, was sleeping underneath her chair. Once the printer started spitting out Glimmer's music, Miette woke up and her mom looked over. "Is that sheet music?"

"Yeah, I'm auditioning for the school musical tomorrow." She said.

"Really?" Angella asked, standing and looking at Glimmer's music as it finished printing. "When did you decide that?"

"Earlier today," She said. "Perfuma came to convince Bow to audition before school because they don't have enough boys, and I decided to sign up, too."

"So Bow is auditioning, too?"

Glimmer nodded. Miette started rubbing her head against her leg.

"What's the show?"

"*Cinderella*," She said, scooping Miette into her arms and scratching her head.

"I see. So your friend, the tall blonde that was in *Light in the Piazza* with you last year- do you think she'll play Cinderella?"

"Perfuma is in an opera like, a week later," Glimmer explained. "So she isn't playing Cinderella."

"I see," Angella said. "Well, I think you'll make a beautiful Cinderella, my love." Angella said, kissing the top of her daughter's head.

"I wouldn't count on it," Glimmer said, but she smiled all the same. "I'm going to Bow's, is that alright?"

"Of course, darling," Angella said almost absently, already absorbed in her work again. Glimmer set Miette back on the floor, gathered her sheet music, and left the room.

oOo

Glimmer loved Bow's house. Of course she appreciated her own house, with its towering ceilings and modern appliances, but after her dad passed away, she couldn't help feeling that there was too much house for two people and one cat. Bow's family, however,

occupied nearly every inch of their home. Even now that Bow was the only child in the house, there was evidence of all thirteen of his older siblings everywhere. Family portraits hung on the walls, art projects were magnetized to the refrigerator, and awards and trophies adorned the floor-to-ceiling bookshelves.

Glimmer’s favorite photo on their wall was one of her and Bow at their eighth grade formal, two years before Adora had started hanging out with them. That was the year that Bow had gotten taller than her, and the year they had both gotten their braces off. When she compared the photo to how she and Bow looked now, she was surprised at how much they had changed. Her hair was still curly and bright pink, her eyes were still wide and violet (though she had, blessedly, gotten much better at doing her eye makeup), and her cheeks were still round and rosy, but just three years ago, she had looked like a child. Recently, she had found her eighth grade formal dress and knew, without trying it on, that it wouldn't fit over her chest, let alone her hips. As for Bow, she couldn't remember when his shoulders got so broad or when his jawline had gotten so sharp. His dads had always teased him about what a handsome man he was growing into, but now she found herself agreeing with them.

Even without looking at the walls, there were millions of memories seeped into every surface of every room. Glimmer and Bow had spent countless hours watching movies on that sofa, studying and doing homework at that kitchen table, to say nothing of almost every Saturday of their lives that they had spent together. They had been so close for so long that Bow’s house was as much home to her as her own.

Today, they were sitting in the den, side-by-side on the piano bench, looking over their audition music. Or rather, Glimmer was watching Bow playing the notes of his song, trying to ignore the knot of anxiety forming in her stomach.

“I should have stayed in piano lessons,” Glimmer said glumly.

“Well, here,” Bow said, taking her sheet music and setting it on the stand. “What do you need help with?”

“I know the song,” She said. “I just…never mind.”

“Hey, not never mind,” Bow said. “What’s up? You look nervous.”

“I am nervous,” She admitted. “I haven’t auditioned for anything in over a year, and it’s not like I was really great at it to begin with.”

“What are you nervous about?”

“I don’t know,” She said. “It’s not like I’m a great singer to begin with-“

“Neither am I.” Bow reminded her. “Remember what Perfuma said about my falsetto?”

“I think Perfuma forgets that not everyone was born with a three-octave range.” Glimmer sighed.

“You know, you sing in front of me all the time.” Bow said. “When we’re in the car or when we’re cooking- so why is this any different?”

“Because that’s with you,” She explained.

“Then sing for me,” Bow said. “That should make it easier, right?”

Glimmer considered this for a moment before a shy smile crossed her lips.

“I think I can do that,” She said. “I think that should work.”

“That’s my girl,” Bow said, wrapping his arm around her shoulders. “You’ll be great, I know you will.”

Glimmer smiled and nuzzled against Bow’s neck.

And the next afternoon, when she walked into the auditorium to audition, she didn’t see Netossa, their music director, and Spinnerella, the head of the drama department, sitting in the audience. In fact, she was barely onstage at all. She was sitting in the passenger seat of her car, watching Bow drive and singing her for him.

Before she knew it, her audition was over, and her small audience was smiling at her.

“Well done, Glimmer,” Netossa said. “We’re so happy you chose to audition.”

“Thank you,” She said, smiling. Before she could turn to go, Netossa stopped her.

“There are some scenes on the piano, would you mind reading the first one for us?”

Glimmer was surprised as she grabbed the sheets of paper from the piano- normally, directors sent her away right after she sang.

“Alright, I’ll read for Christopher, okay? Go ahead and read Cinderella’s lines.”

Glimmer swallowed- she was reading for Cinderella? Her heart rate elevated. She had never been asked to read scenes after an audition, and now she was reading for the lead role?

Breathe, she told herself. Just- just pretend it’s Bow. Pretend you're just reading a scene with Bow.

As soon as she convinced herself that she was reading a scene with Bow instead of with Netossa, the scene flew by. Reading had been easy- the acting had been easy. When she finished, both Netossa and Spinnerella were smiling even wider.

“Alight, Glimmer,” Netossa said. “Thank you very much. We’ll post the cast list on Friday after school, alright?”

Glimmer nodded her head and thanked her directors before she left the auditorium. As soon as the stage door closed behind her, a wave of relief and something resembling joy washed over her.

She had had a *good* audition, because she had sung for Bow. Apparently she had sounded good enough that they wanted her to read for Cinderella.

But did that mean that she should even get her hopes up? Before, she would have considered herself lucky to be cast as one of the stepsisters.

Glimmer took her phone out of her pocket and called Bow, who answered after the second ring.

“Hey, what’s up?” He asked. “Are you done with your audition?”

“I actually just finished,” She said, making her way down the stairs and towards the parking lot.

“How was it?”

“It was…”

She stopped herself. All they had done was ask her to read a single scene- for all she knew, they probably asked everyone to read at least one scene, especially since they weren’t doing callbacks.

“Glimmer?” Bow asked. “You still there?”

“What? Yes!” She said, unlocking the door to her car and climbing inside. “Yeah, it went well. Better than I thought it would.”

“That’s great!” He said. “See? I told you you would be great.”

Glimmer smiled and started her car. “Yes, you were right, like always. How was yours?”

“It was fine- wait, are you driving?”

“I’m not even out of the parking lot,” She said. “I’m being perfectly safe.”

“Well, I will tell you everything once you get home, alright?”

Glimmer sighed. “Alright, Bow. I expect all of the details.”

“And you will receive them as soon as you are no longer behind the wheel of a vehicle.”

“Goodbye, Bow,” She said, rolling her eyes.

“Drive safe, Glimmer.” Bow said, matching her exaggerated, exasperated tone before he hung up. When Glimmer reached a stop sign, she started playing a cast recording of *Cinderella*, wondering if she would wind up singing any of the songs before a larger audience.

oOo

It was colder the next morning, which brought Adora, Bow, and Glimmer inside before school instead of leading them to the steps outside the front doors.

“So when will the cast list be posted?” Adora asked.

“Not until tomorrow after school,” Glimmer said. Adora raised an eyebrow.

“You seem a little nervous,” She said.

“I- no, not really,” Glimmer said. “Honestly, I don't know how the cast list is actually going to shake out.”

“Ah,” Adora said, nodding her head. “I mean, isn't there any other soprano who can play our Cinderella? Perfuma can't be the only one."

“Cinderella isn’t a soprano- not really,” Glimmer said. “I listened to a recording last night, and she could easily be played by a mezzo.”

“You’re a mezzo,” Bow reminded her. Glimmer rolled her eyes.

“That’s sweet, Bow, but they’d cast Adora as Cinderella before they cast me.”

Adora laughed. “Glimmer, you know I’m tone deaf.”

“And we could never unmoor you from the rock that is the Set Crew,” Bow supposed. Glimmer considered this- yes, Adora was the captain of the set building crew and couldn’t carry a tune to save her life, but in Glimmer’s head, she looked like a Cinderella, with her shiny blonde hair and bright blue eyes. Sure, she was tall and broad shouldered, but in her head, Cinderella was stately and lovely, two things that Perfuma, Adora, and Mermista certainly were.

“Well, something needs to keep me off the streets until softball season,” Adora reminded them. “Speaking of, how was your audition, Bow?”

Bow shrugged. “They said I did well, they had me to a quick reading for Christopher. I guess they have more faith in my falsetto than Perfuma does.”

“I don’t know what a falsetto is, but I’m glad it went well,” Adora said. “C’mon, we’ll be late to class.”

“Do you really think that Perfuma isn’t going to play Cinderella?” Glimmer asked as they started walking down the hallway.

“She said that she can’t play Cinderella and Pamina at the same time,” Bow reminded her.

“Yes, Pamina the ingenue in *The Magic Flute*,” Adora added before walking up the stairs to her next class, leaving Bow and Glimmer by themselves.

“What if Perfuma needs to play Cinderella, though? What if there’s no one else who can? We can’t exactly do the show without one,” Glimmer said. “She’s a little important.”

“Perfuma isn’t the only princess who’s auditioning,” Bow told her, squeezing her hand. Glimmer hadn’t even noticed that she was still holding on. “Now get to class, you.”

Glimmer waved goodbye to Bow and watched him walk down the hallway, feeling herself smile about Bow thinking that she was a princess.

oOo

Glimmer tapped her pen on the edge of her notebook. Two minutes until the end of class. Two minutes until she saw the Cinderella cast list. Why was she so nervous? She knew what was coming- Mermista was going to grudgingly accept the leading role, or Perfuma was going to heroically step in after realizing that she could play two leads simultaneously. And she herself would maybe wind up playing her third named role in a musical.

As for Bow-

The end-of-the-day bell rang, shocking Glimmer out of her thoughts.

"Are you alright?" Adora asked, closing her notebook and putting it in her bag. "You just about jumped out of your skin."

"I'm fine, it just caught me off guard," She said, quickly packing her things. "Are you ready to go see the cast list?"

"Sure," Adora answered, noting just how hard Glimmer was trying to sound casual, and how much faster she walked down the

hallway back towards the choir room, where two sheets of light blue paper were taped to the door.

Glimmer's name was the first one on the first page.

"I- what?" Glimmer said, staring at her name on the cast list without believing what she saw. "I- I'm…"

"You're Cinderella," Adora said, reading over her shoulder. "Wow, that's awesome!"

"No I'm not," Glimmer said, shaking her head. "Where's- Perfuma!"

Those blonde curls whirled around towards her, and she smiled as Glimmer ran out of the choir corridor and down the hallway towards her.

"Perfuma, what's going on?" She asked. "I just saw the cast list-"

"I know!" She said, walking forward and hugging her. "Congratulations, Cinderella!"

"But- I don't understand." Glimmer said, still dazed. "What happened?"

“Well, I assume because Nestossa and Spinnerella thought you would play the role well.” Perfuma explained.

“So- so it’s not a mistake?” Glimmer asked. Perfuma shook her head.

“I’m Cinderella,” She said aloud, looking at Perfuma, then back at Adora. “I’m playing Cinderella.”

“Yes, you are,” Perfuma confirmed, taking her hand and squeezing it. “You and Bow will be precious together.”

“What?” Glimmer asked, feeling, for the second time in thirty seconds, like the wind had just been knocked out of her. “Me and who?”

“Glimmer, did you read the whole list?”

“I didn’t really- well…”

“You should go and look at the whole thing,” Perfuma said, releasing her hand. “I’ll see you on Monday, alright? Be ready for rehearsal!”

Glimmer dazedly walked back down the hallway and took another look at the list.

"So Bow is playing the prince?" Adora said.

"Bow is playing Christopher," She said aloud. "And I'm playing Cinderella."

"Bow is playing who?"

Glimmer whirled around and saw Bow walking down the hallway.

"Orchestra ran late," He explained. "What did I- oh…"

His eyes stayed stuck on the cast list, then turned to Glimmer.

"Congrats, you!" He said, pulling her into his arms. "I always knew you were a princess!"

Glimmer felt her chest unclench for the first time since seeing the cast list- after all, Bow was the one who would be most effected by who would play Cinderella, and if he was happy, shouldn't she be, as well?

“You too,” She said, wrapping her arms around his middle.

“My dads will be ecstatic,” He said, loosening his embrace, but still keeping an arm around her shoulders. “And your mom is going to be so proud!”

Glimmer smiled, finally allowing herself to feel happy about how the casting had shaken out. She was a princess.

And she was going to play her first lead in a musical alongside her best friend.

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Angella's car was in the driveway when Glimmer came home from school after dropping Bow off at his house.

"Mom?" She called as she walked inside.

"In here, dear," She called from the office. Glimmer set her backpack on a kitchen chair and walked towards her mom's voice.

"How was school?" Angella asked, turning towards the doorway when Glimmer arrived. Miette was asleep in her lap.

"It was fine- Mom, I'm playing Cinderella. In the school musical."

"You- Glimmer!" She said, rising from her chair, waking up Miette. "Darling, that's wonderful!"

Glimmer smiled and accepted her hug.

"Promise me that you'll tell me if that Hawkins boy starts getting on your nerves- I know his mother-"

“Sea Hawk isn’t in the show,” She said. “He didn’t audition.”

“Who’s playing Prince Charming, then?” Angella asked.

“Prince Christopher,” Glimmer corrected. “And Bow is.”

“Your Bow?” She asked. Glimmer nodded her head, and her mother’s smile grew. “Well, that’s just perfect, isn’t it?”

“I- yeah, it is,” She said. Angella raised an eyebrow.

“What’s wrong?” She asked. “Is Bow unhappy?”

“No, Bow’s- Bow is going to be great, but-“ She frowned. “Cinderella and Christopher are in love, Mom.”

“Yes, if I recall, that’s the crux of the entire plot.”

“Do you think- is that going to be- is that going to be weird for us?”

Angella shook her head. “Not at all. You and Bow are so comfortable with one another already, all you’ll have to do is play

a role.”

Glimmer nodded her head. Cinderella was a role- she and Bow would pretend to be in love for a show.

“Alright, Mom,” She said.

“Now,” Angella said. “Do you have plans tonight?”

“Probably,” She said. “Bow’s Dads are making homemade pasta.”

“Alright, my darling. I want you home by eleven.”

“Yes mom,” Glimmer said.

“I’ve got to get back to work,” Angella said, kissing the top of Glimmer’s head- she was so much taller than Glimmer that she almost exclusively kissed the top of her head. “But I’m so proud of you.”

“Thanks, mom,” Glimmer said. She left the office, Miette following her.

oOo

Monday afternoon brought Adora to the auditorium, surrounded by the entire tech, set, and costume crew of the musical. Netossa outlined the schedule for the crew- over the next six weeks, while the cast rehearsed onstage, the crew would be building a living room, village, and ballroom set, the costume crew would be finding and making finery for the small cast, and Entrapta, a junior who was the sole person on the lighting and sound crew, would work on her lighting design.

When the meeting was adjourned, Netossa approached Adora.

“Adora, I was wondering if you would be willing to come with me to pick up some lumber for the set,” She said. “You have a truck, don’t you?”

“Yeah, of course,” Adora said, hoping that her truck, a white pickup that she named “Swift Wind” would make the journey there and back.

“Oh, thank goodness,” Netossa said. “We were supposed to borrow my brother’s, but his is in the shop and then my Spinny said it would have to wait until tomorrow, but then we would be behind schedule, but now I’ve figured it out and I win!”

Adora smiled- she liked Netossa a lot and couldn't help being charmed by her loving rivalry with her wife and co-director.

“Let me go grab my jacket, and I’ll meet you outside, alright?” Netossa asked. Adora nodded her head and turned to go.

All at once, all of the air left her lungs.

Why was she…

Was she?

Wait, no- it couldn’t have been…

Adora blinked, expecting the person standing a few feet in front of her to change into someone else, or to disappear entirely.

But she stayed there. She kept talking to Entrapta, she kept pushing her long, untidy curls out of her face. She kept frowning.

But she never looked over at Adora, even when she said goodbye to Entrapta and left the auditorium.

Adora walked over to Entrapta, her eyes still on the door.

“Adora?” Entrapta asked, snapping her out of her thoughts. “Is everything alright?”

“Yeah, I’m fine,” Adora said. “I just- you have some new people on the tech crew.”

“Do you mean Catra?” Entrapta asked. Adora nodded. “I thought you two knew one another.”

“We- we do, but what is she doing on the tech crew?”

“We needed some extra hands, and Catra’s habit of being late to class landed her in some trouble, and she said that tech crew would be ‘slightly better than detention.’”

Adora furrowed her brow.

“I’m sensing distress,” Entrapta said.

“I’m fine,” Adora said, shaking her head. “I’m just- just surprised.”

“I was too,” Entrapta agreed. “If anything, I would have thought she would join the set crew, since you’re in charge.”

“She could have joined the set crew?”

“Or the costume crew,” She added. “But I guess the tech crew

spoke to her. I don't know why, but it will be nice to have some company in the sound booth."

"Yeah," Adora said. "That's great, Entrapta. I'll see you in the work room, okay?"

"Bye, Adora!" Entrapta called as she left the auditorium.

oOo

Bow and Glimmer were sitting in the choir corridor when Adora came out of the auditorium. Evidently, they had used their free hour between the end of school and the start of rehearsal to get bubble tea.

"It was absolutely time to get boba," Bow was saying. "Because last Thursday we got coffee, remember?"

"But then we got smoothies over the weekend because Adora ran out of pre-workout," Glimmer said.

"That still means that it was time to get boba. We have a system, we rotate between the coffee shop, the boba stand, and the smoothie station! Society has rules, Glimmer. Right, Adora? Wait, what's the matter?"

Glimmer looked up at Adora.

"Catra is on the tech crew," Adora said numbly, sitting beside Bow.

"Really? Why?" Glimmer asked.

"I don't- I don't know," Adora said. "I mean, I know why, it's an alternative to detention- but apparently she could have been on the set crew with me, and…"

"I mean, Adora, you two haven't really been close for a while," Bow reminded her gently. "Not since the start of the summer."

"I know, but I thought that- I don't know, if she had to be involved in the musical, she would have chosen…" She shook her head.

"Did you ever find out why she was upset with you?" Glimmer asked.

"No, she just…just kind of stopped texting me back. We haven't really gotten to talk since then."

Bow put his hand on Adora's knee. "I'm sorry, Adora."

"Don't be, it's just- it's just weird, right?" She asked. "I mean, she just wakes up the morning after Scorpia's party and is all bent out of shape, and she won't even talk to me about it? It's been months, I would have thought that…"

Apparently she and Catra had been best friends for years, but then at the start of sophomore year, something started to drive them apart. Of course Glimmer and Bow had been friends with Adora before, but gradually, Adora started sitting with them at lunch and hanging out with them before and after school much more often. Over time, they became a trio all of their own. This was solidified at the beginning of the past Summer when Adora had been with Catra at their mutual friend Scorpia's party. The next morning, Adora woke up with a hangover (somehow Scorpia had acquired some cheap vodka, a substance that Adora hadn't experienced previously and hadn't touched since) and a notification that Catra had unfollowed her on every social media platform she could. Her texts went unanswered. Unanswered texts turned into unanswered calls, and eventually Catra stopped being a friend and started being a story.

Glimmer could hardly imagine her life without Adora and could tell that she was happy, but she couldn't miss how sad Adora's eyes got whenever Catra was mentioned. She could tell she missed her.

"We got you a tea," Bow said, handing Adora a cup. "It's raspberry, with the mango jellies that you like."

Adora took her tea and smiled. "Thanks, you guys."

“You deserve it,” Glimmer said. “Look, we need to go rehearsal, will you be okay?”

“Sure,” Adora said, trying to sound offhand. “I’m supposed to be running an errand with Netossa anyway, and I’ll go for a run or something after.”

“Are you sure?” Bow asked.

Adora nodded her head. “You two have fun, okay?”

Both Bow and Glimmer waved goodbye and went into the auditorium. Glimmer’s thoughts were still full of Adora when they sat down in the front row. Her heart ached for her friend- she couldn’t imagine how awful it would be to lose Bow after so many years of being in one another’s lives.

Before she could stop herself, she leaned over and hugged Bow.

“Uh- hi, Glimmer,” He said, hugging her back. “Is everything okay?”

“I’m just happy you’re here,” She said. She heard Bow laugh as he pulled her closer to him.

“I am too,” He said.

Before Glimmer could reply, Spinnerella called the cast to order and passed out scripts, starting their first rehearsal.

oOo

After a week of read-throughs, music rehearsals, and one viewing of a made-for-TV filmed version of *Cinderella*, Glimmer felt like she was swimming in a sea of glass slippers.

“Alright, so we have to be off-book in two weeks," Glimmer said on Monday afternoon, looking over the rehearsal schedule as she and Bow sat in her car at the smoothie stand drive-thru. “That’s… overwhelming.”

“You do have a lot of lines," Bow sympathized.

"So do you, and you aren't whining.” Glimmer said. “And I thought lyrics would be easier to memorize, but I still get the damn verses during the My Own Little Corner song mixed up.”

“You were just singing the intro a few minutes ago," Bow reminded her.

“Alright, but I couldn't forget ‘I'm as mild and as meek as a mouse / when I hear a command I obey’ if I tried,” Glimmer said,

wrinkling her nose.

Bow handed her smoothie across the center console and set Adora's in the cupholder. “You two are pretty different, huh?”

“Maybe that’s where the acting thing comes in,” She said.

"It's funny how that works, isn't it?”

Glimmer laughed, which was a welcome distraction from her haze of ingenue annoyance.

“You weren’t whining, you know," He said as they reached the school parking lot.

“I was certainly complaining.”

Bow rolled his eyes and handed her her car keys.

“Maybe you should hold onto those, you're probably going to drive us home," Glimmer said.

Glimmer’s silver Volkswagon had been a gift for her sixteenth birthday in January, while Bow’s personal mode of transportation was a highly unreliable mini van that all twelve of his siblings had driven before he had. A combination of Bow’s apprehension over Glimmer’s driving habits (Glimmer maintained the opinion that stop signs were a suggestion) and Glimmer’s distaste for driving lead to Bow or Adora being in the driver's seat about as often as she was.

“I’m going to help Adora with some painting,” Bow told Glimmer before she entered the auditorium. “We're not supposed to get into my stuff until five, so I'll see you then, okay?”

Glimmer nodded her head and walked into the auditorium. Within five minutes, she was walking out again after Netossa sent her and Perfuma to the choir room to rehearse their duet.

“How is *The Magic Flute* going?” Glimmer asked Perfuma, setting her music on top of the piano.

“Actually really well,” Glimmer said. “Pamina is a hard role, but I like a challenge. And her arc is really lovely, so that’s always a good time.”

“Lucky you,” Glimmer said, a hint of bitterness in her voice.

“Oh?” Perfuma asked. “Is something wrong?”

“Nothing, you're just lucky to have an arc at all.” Glimmer said. “Cinderella is like, the character equivalent of a vanilla cupcake.”

Perfuma looked up from the piano, her eyes boring into Glimmer’s.

“Excuse me?” She asked. “What on earth does that mean?”

“I mean she’s kinda…boring,” Glimmer said.

“Glimmer, if you think that Cinderella is boring, how can you expect our audience to not be bored, too?" Perfuma asked, her tone harsher than Glimmer would have ever imagined.

"I-"

"Is that what you want?”

“I- no,” Glimmer said. “I don’t.”

Perfuma’s eyes softened as she studied Glimmer for a moment.

“Look, I didn’t mean to snap at you,” Perfuma said. “But Cinderella is actually a really, really special role.”

“Oh,” Glimmer said, feeling almost chastened. “I- I guess I’m just seeing her wrong.”

“Glimmer, you aren't seeing her wrong,” Perfuma said. “I mean, when you play a role, you don’t see them. You find them. You make them. And there’s plenty of time for you to find your Cinderella.”

“You think so?” Glimmer asked, surprised at how comforted she was at Perfuma’s words.

“Oh, absolutely. That’s the exciting part,” Perfuma said, smiling. “But tell me, why do you think she’s boring?”

“She’s just- well, she always does the right thing and always does what she’s told, you know? And Christopher doesn’t fall in love with her because of who she is, it’s because she’s pretty.” Glimmer said.

“Alright, I could see that,” Perfuma said. “Let’s take these one at a time, alright?”

Glimmer nodded.

“So, she always does the right thing and does what she’s told. Have you thought about why that might be?”

“Because her mom tells her that it’s important to be kind, right?” Glimmer said. “That’s what you say at the start of the show.”

“Alright, do you think that's true?” Perfuma asked. “Do you think it’s only because of her mom?”

Glimmer furrowed her brow. “I…I don't know. I don't think her stepfamily deserves her being kind.”

“So why do you think she’s kind to them?” Perfuma asks. “Why do you think she keeps doing their chores?”

“Because they’re all she has,” Glimmer answered. “And maybe… maybe she’s still holding out the hope that maybe, eventually, they’re going to return the favor, but they never do. And they never will.”

Perfuma shook her head. “You’re right.”

“Cinderella’s been through a lot. She’s…a survivor.” Glimmer realized aloud.

“Yes she is,” Perfuma said proudly. “As for doing everything she's told, her stepmother tells her that she can’t go to the ball.”

“Alright, but that's doing the right thing,” Glimmer added.

“Uh-huh, go on.”

“But to do that, she has to defy her shitty family, who she's actively afraid of.” Glimmer stopped for a moment. “That’s…she’s actually pretty strong, then.”

“Yes she is,” Perfuma agreed. “Now, as for why Prince Christopher falls in love with her, do you really think it's just because she’s pretty?”

“Well, that can’t hurt, can it?” She asked. “He sees her in the village and is immediately taken with her, then he sees her at the ball and decides pretty much immediately that he wants to marry her.”

“But they have a lot in common, remember? They talk about it in the garden.”

“He wouldn't have even looked at her if she wasn’t pretty, though,” Glimmer said stubbornly.

“Well, maybe that’s a question for Bow to answer,” Perfuma said. “The real question is why you think Cinderella falls in love with

him.”

Glimmer thought for a moment- just five minutes ago, her answer would have been “because he is a way out of her house,” but now she figured that Cinderella, after having discovered her agency, probably would have left her stepmother’s house on her own eventually, anyway.

“Because he’s kind, just like she is.” She said. “And that's probably the biggest thing they have in common, and- what?”

Perfuma was looking at Glimmer strangely- her huge eyes were shining and a smile was playing with her lips.

“You’re starting to think like a leading lady,” Perfuma said. “And I’m proud of you.”

“Don’t give me too much credit, five minutes ago I hadn’t even considered any of this.”

“You just needed a little help,” Perfuma said. “And there’s no shame in that.”

“Thanks, Perfuma,” Glimmer said.

“It’s my pleasure. We’re castmates, we’re supposed to help one another.”

“Speaking of, maybe we should look at the song?”

“Oh, right!” Perfuma said, sitting back down on the piano bench. “Right. Let’s learn a song!”

oOo

“Alright, one iced dirty chai, one caramel macchiato, and one iced vanilla latte,” Bow said, distributing coffees to Glimmer and Adora, who were working on painting the living room set at the end of the week.

“Thanks, Bow,” Glimmer said, setting down her paintbrush and taking a long sip of her coffee.

“I thought you would be onstage by now,” He said to Glimmer. “Aren’t they teaching the Lovely Night blocking today?”

“Spinnerella is running late on the blocking,” She said. “We might not even get to my scenes today.”

“We're supposed to have the whole show blocked tomorrow,” Bow said, sounding worried.

“Well,” Glimmer said. "Maybe we should start running our lines more outside of rehearsal, since we might not get as many run-throughs.”

The door to the workroom opened and Perfuma walked inside, her face lighting up as soon as she saw Glimmer.

“Oh, good, I wanted to catch you before you went home," Perfuma said, walking to her. “I was thinking about our conversation earlier this week-” She handed her a scrap of paper with a title scribbled onto it. “-and I thought you would like this. It’s one of the best Cinderella adaptations ever, and it will probably inform your character choices better.”

“*The Glass Slipper* with Leslie Caron,” Glimmer read.

“Just trust me,” She said. “You’ll love it.”

Perfuma waved goodbye to Adora, Bow, and Glimmer.

“So, *The Glass Slipper*?” Bow asked. “What’s up with that?”

Glimmer had already taken out her phone and was doing quick research on Perfuma's suggested film.

“Leslie Caron was 22 when she played Cinderella- oh wow, she's almost 80 now." She looked up at her friends. “How do we feel about watching a movie that's older than all of our parents?” Glimmer asked them.

“Is it a musical?” Adora asked.

“It’s a ballet, actually.” She said.

“Well, you've convinced me,” Bow said. “I can ask Dads if I can host tonight, since it's not a school night.”

Bow was correct about his Dads letting them use their house- after rehearsal, Adora, Bow, and Glimmer were sitting on his living room sofa and the opening overture of *The Glass Slipper* was onscreen.

“I feel so sophisticated,” Adora said. “Look at us, watching an old movie- no, an old film.”

“I know, right?” Glimmer said. “Are we…better than everyone else?”

“We just might- wait, sorry,” Adora said, pulling her vibrating phone out of her pocket. Bow paused the movie while she answered.

“Hi, Scorpia. What? Okay, slow down…” She listened for a long moment. “Okay, okay, I’ll be right there- yes, we have to fix it tonight so they can rehearse with it tomorrow. Okay, yes. No, I promise you’re alright, we’ll fix it. Okay, I’ll see you soon.”

Adora hung up her phone and grabbed her jacket.

“The living room set collapsed,” Adora explained.

“What? How?” Glimmer asked. “It was fine this afternoon.”

“I have no idea,” She said. “But I’ve got to run to the auditorium and fix it.”

“Do you want us to come with you?” Bow asked. “We could help.”

Adora shook her head. “Netossa is already on her way- she and Scorpia and I can handle it, and I think she’s trying to keep it quiet. From the way she sounded, Scorpia blames herself for it falling apart.”

“Are you sure?” Glimmer asked

“Positive,” Adora said, walking towards the door. “I’ll see you both tomorrow, okay?”

“Alright, bye Adora! Let us know how it goes.”

Adora waved and left, they could hear Swift Wind’s engine starting and puttering down the street as she drove away.

“That’s terrible,” Glimmer said, slumping back onto the sofa. “About the set, I mean.”

Bow nodded his head. “Though I think Adora isn’t heartbroken about missing two hours of Leslie Caron’s ballet skills.”

“Good think *you’re* stuck with me,” Glimmer said, resting her head against Bow’s shoulder. He smiled at her and started the movie. Perfuma had been right- Cinderella, or Ella, as she was called in *The Glass Slipper*, was precocious and stubborn, but also sweet and strong and fiery, just like Glimmer.

“Her dress is pink,” Glimmer said, nuzzling against Bow’s chest. “More Cinderella dresses should be pink- I think ours is going to be blue. Spinnerella mentioned something about borrowing costumes from the community college since they did the show like, five years ago."

“You look nice in blue,” He said.

“Not the point,” She said, pulling at the hem of her lavender baby tee over an exposed strip of her stomach. “And not my signature color.”

Bow smiled and rested his chin atop her head. “I think she and Prince Charles are sweet together.”

“I guess so- but they’ve still only known each other for a couple of days.”

“It’s love at first sight?”

“I guess so, but I still don’t buy it. I mean, I know that Charles had been traveling, so he didn’t have much of a chance to run into Ella, but there’s something about meeting someone and knowing a few days later that you love them enough to spend your life with them.”

“It’s a fairytale,” Bow reminded her. “It’s not like things happen like that in real life- at least, not very often. I’m pretty sure there’s normally a crush first, then maybe coffee. Maybe lots of coffee.”

“And probably knowing one another for longer. Much longer, maybe even years.”

“Well,” Bow said, jostling her in his arms. “Maybe when the show closes, you can write a Cinderella musical where Cinderella and

her prince know each other for years- maybe even grow up together.”

Glimmer was glad that Bow couldn’t see her face and prayed he didn’t feel how her stomach did a tiny somersault.

Cinderella and her prince falling in love after having grown up together. Years of knowing one another.

As bravely as she could, she looked up at him, hoping she looked more nonchalant than she felt.

“I could believe that,” She said. Bow smiled and opened his mouth to reply, so it made perfect sense that Glimmer was looking at his mouth-

“Did I miss the whole thing? Oh, wow, that dress is really pretty. Glimmer, does yours look like that?”

Glimmer, just about jumping out of her skin, snapped her head towards Adora.

“Hi, Adora,” She said, instead of answering her question.

“Did you get the set fixed?” Bow asked.

“Yeah, it was an easy fix, actually.” Adora sat beside Glimmer on the sofa. “Are they in love yet?”

“Huh?” Glimmer asked, sitting up and out of Bow’s arms so he wouldn’t feel the racing of her heart.

“Cinderella and Prince Christopher,” Adora said, narrowing her gaze and pointing to the TV. “Are they in love yet?”

“Oh,” Glimmer said, leaning against the back of the sofa.

“Not yet,” Bow answered.

Glimmer nodded her head, trying not to be distracted by the (not entirely unpleasant) twinge in her stomach.

Not yet.

Chapter End Notes

Hi friends, here is a second chapter for your reading pleasure.

1. I wound up watching The Glass Slipper late at night like, six years ago, and it has been my favorite Cinderella adaptation since, and my main comfort movie. So, because Ella is adorable, and a lot more like Glimmer than 97.2% of all

other Cinderellas, I decided to mention it in my silly little fanfic.

2. I was talking to my roommates about the implications of having Rodgers and Hammerstein exist in this universe- I appreciate R&H for everything they did for musical theatre as a genre, but I'm pretty bored by like...60% of their catalogue. My roommate (and best friend) was the first to remind me that I am allowed to make the rules in this universe, so I've decided that Carousel, Cinderella, and the Sound of Music exist in this universe. Because I do not love the idea of a world without Younger Than Springtime, Something Wonderful, I Have Dreamed, and Love Look Away (and am fully okay with a world were South Pacific, The King and I, and Flower Drum Song), I have decided that there is an anthology of R&H songs that do not have shows to accompany them.

Also, Dear Evan Hansen does not exist in this universe because I hate it.

Anyway, I love you all v much, thank you for reading. I am available on Tumblr @somebodys-muse, please leave comments and kudos if you feel so moved. I appreciate your kind words more than you will ever know.

See you soon! Everyone stay warm.

Love,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

When Glimmer picked up her phone Saturday morning to turn off her alarm, she saw a text from Perfuma.

PERFUMA: I have to leave rehearsal early today, would you mind taking Frosta home?

GLIMMER: Of course.

She yawned and started to get ready for the day, spraying dry shampoo into her curls. A long day of rehearsal awaited her- they had to catch up on all the blocking they hadn't gotten to that week, and Spinnerella wanted to at least to run the entire second act. When she looked at her phone again after pulling her hair back in a claw clip and doing her makeup, Perfuma had texted her back.

PERFUMA: yay! thank you!

GLIMMER: I'm stopping to get coffee, do you want anything?

PERFUMA: I don't drink coffee, thank you though!

GLIMMER: How do you do nine rehearsals a week without coffee?

PERFUMA: caffeine dries out your vocal chords! I drink looooots of water instead.

Glimmer looked down at Perfuma's message and furrowed her brow. Her scowl stayed in place as she got dressed and drove to Bow's house to pick him up.

"Good morning, Glimmer!" He chirped, climbing into the passenger seat. "How did you sleep?"

"Pretty well," she answered. "How did you sleep?"

"Oh, like a baby." He said. "Did you have breakfast?"

"Do I ever have breakfast?" She asked.

"That's what I thought," He said. "It's lucky I brought you a muffin."

"Bow," She very nearly groaned. "It's not your job to feed me."

“But I’ve been doing it for so long, how do you expect me to stop?” He asked.

Glimmer rolled her eyes and pulled into the school’s parking lot. “What kind of muffin?” She asked.

“Blueberry,” he answered. “Dad baked them fresh this morning.”

Glimmer took another long look at him, then at the still-hot muffin that he was handing her from across the center console.

“It’s not your job to feed me,” She said again.

“It’s not a job,” Bow said. Glimmer relented and took it from him. “Call it a privilege.”

Glimmer’s cheeks warmed, and that fluttering she had felt in her stomach the night before was back.

“We should go inside,” She said before the pause got too long. “Before they can call us late.”

oOo

“So you think that there was foul play involved,” Glimmer said. “And you think that the Stepmother is just widowed.”

“No no,” Frosta said. “There’s more than that. I think she was really in love with her first husband-“

“With your dad-“

“Yes, with my dad,” Frosta agreed. “And she was jaded by love and nonsense after that, so when she married her new husband,”

“My papa,” Glimmer reminded her.

“Yes, your papa, she was really just about it for the money.”

Glimmer laughed. She and Frosta had met at the start of the school year in their shared homeroom and despite the two years between them, they had quickly become friends.

“Okay, well, he’s my husband, so I think I would know if I killed him or not," Mermista said from her armchair. Glimmer hadn’t talked to Mermista much before the start of musical rehearsals, but it hadn’t taken her long to appreciate her dry sense of humor.

“Are you confessing?” Frosta asked, resting her chin on the arm of Mermista’s chair.

“Be careful, I’ll make you sweep ashes, too.” Mermista said.

“Finally, some company in my own little corner,” Glimmer said.

“Okay everyone, break is over!” Spinnerella called from the front of the room. “We are almost done with our blocking! All that's left is the end of the garden scene with you two,” she pointed to Bow and Glimmer.

Mermista and Frosta went to sit in the audience with the rest of the cast while Bow came onstage from the wings. Spinnerella taught the blocking for their scene quickly, and walked them through some acting choices for their duet.

“I’ve seen this song done a couple of times where Christopher and Cinderella stay away from one another until the end, but with you two, I think the more we have you together, the better,” Spinnerella said. “Alright, we taught the choreography last week- go ahead and get into position for the end of that number…alright, good."

Glimmer’s arms were around Bow's neck, his were circled around her waist. She fought the urge to stand on her toes to see him better.

“Alright, that looks great,” Spinnerella asked. “Now, I know you two are pretty close, aren't you?”

They both nodded their heads.

“How would you two feel about kissing at the end of this song?"

Kissing.

Kissing Bow.

Kissing Bow at the end of their song.

At sixteen, Glimmer hadn’t had her first kiss yet, mostly because she hadn't met anyone who she really *wanted* to kiss all that badly.

But if anyone was going to have her first kiss, it may as well be Bow.

And she wouldn't even be the person kissing Bow- Cinderella would kiss Bow.

No, Cinderella would kiss Prince Christopher.

Glimmer looked for a long moment at Spinnerella, then looked over at Bow.

“If you’re not comfortable with that, there’s-“

“I’m fine with it if you are,” Bow said, seemingly finding his voice again.

“It’s fine by me,” Glimmer said. “I mean, I’m comfortable with you.”

“Right,” Bow said. “I’m comfortable with you.”

“Is that a yes, then?” Spinnerella asked. Both Glimmer and Bow nodded. “Then why don't we do this scene from the top?”

As they read and walked through the scene’s blocking, Glimmer was grateful that she didn't have to be off-book for another week, because her hands were shaking.

Why were her hands shaking? At least here voice wasn't shaking during their duet. She was facing him when they finished singing, and Bow leaned towards her. She could feel her heart in her throat- and then it was over.

It was barely a kiss, more of a peck, but her heart kept racing.

When Glimmer looked at Bow, he was smiling, which made it easy to smile back.

“Good?" She asked, raising an eyebrow.

“Good,” Bow answered.

“Those aren't your lines!” Frosta called from the audience, making the entire cast laugh. Glimmer felt her heart rate decrease significantly.

“Well done, you two," Spinnerella said, then turned to the rest of the cast. “Alright everyone, let’s run the second act from the top!”

oOo

Adora walked onto the stage before rehearsal on Monday, carrying an end table for the living room set. She looked out across the rows and rows of empty seats- even when she was alone, it was intimidating up there.

Then there was a noise above her, coming from the catwalk that hung above the stage, hidden by the top of the grand curtain. Almost no one used the catwalk, and Adora was sure that *Cinderella* didn't require its use.

Adora looked up towards the sound- Catra was sitting on the catwalk above the stage. She stared at her outline, just visible through the dark. Before she even knew she was moving, she was walking up the many flights of stairs and ladders up to the catwalk, meeting Catra on the narrow walkway.

"Hey, Adora," She said, barely looking up from her phone.

"I- hi, Catra," She said before the pause got too long. For everything she felt, she was surprised she had a voice at all.

"Are you here to tell me I'm not allowed to be up here?" She asked.

"I- no," Adora said. "Has that ever worked for me before?"

Catra gave a short laugh- the sound sent a tiny shock through Adora's system.

"You won't tell anyone, will you?" She asked.

“No,” Adora said. “I mean, you aren't doing anything wrong."

“Huh, I guess not,” Catra said, setting down her phone and looking at Adora.

“So what are you doing up here?” She asked, walking closer to Catra.

“Nothing,” She answered. “I just like coming up here when the auditorium is empty.”

“Ah,” Adora said. “It's kind of like how we used to sneak onto the roof of Lonnie’s apartment complex-

“There was no ‘we’ there, Adora, the whole time you were all ‘oh, Catra we’re going to get in trouble! Catra what if you fall and break your neck?’”

“I do not sound like that!” Adora said, sitting beside Catra.

“It’s lucky I’m not onstage, then,” Catra said. “Just pointing spotlights and listening to Entrapta talk about different gels.”

“What even are gels?” Adora asked.

“They’re for lights,” Catra said.

“Wow, look at you, lighting expert.”

“Right, these three weeks of experience have made me a lighting genius. I’ll put Entrapta out of work.”

Adora laughed and looked down at the stage below her. Everything about the auditorium was far less intimidating from her height.

“It’s really cool up here,” Adora said.

“You aren’t worried about falling and breaking your neck?” Catra asked.

“Not this time," She said.

“You weren’t last time, either,” Catra said.

“You literally just made fun of me for being afraid of Lonnie's roof-“

“No, no, we climbed on top of Scorpia’s pool house, remember?” Catra said. Her voice was different, almost softer. Adora looked away from the ground below her and at the girl beside her.

“We climbed on top of Scorpia’s pool house?” Adora asked. “Wow, how plastered was I?”

“You really don’t remember anything about that night, do you?” Catra asked, her eyes narrowed.

“I remember lots of regrets in the morning,” She said, smiling. Catra didn't smile back- she glared and turned away. “Catra?”

“You have lots of regrets,” Catra said slowly.

“I- I mean, yes. I went to Glimmer’s that day and slept on her couch for hours, then Bow made me drink like, a small truckload of water-“

“Yeah, I bet he did.” Catra said, crossing her arms. “Did you get the living room set fixed?”

“I- yeah, but how did you know about that?"

“You aren't the only one who can see the workroom, Adora. Entrapta and I are in there sometimes, too.”

“Catra-“

"Bow and Glimmer are probably looking for you, Adora.” Catra said, obviously dismissing her. “And you should probably go make sure none of your other sets implode."

Adora watched Catra for a moment, trying to find something to say. Eventually, she left Catra sitting on the catwalk, not even glancing at her as she walked away.

oOo

Bow left orchestra rehearsal on Monday morning and found Glimmer sitting in the choir corridor, sitting cross-legged with her script in her lap.

“Hey, you,” He said, sitting beside her.

“Hi, Bow,” she said, looking up at him and smiling. “How was orchestra?”

“I am swimming in music,” He said. “I close my eyes and see eighth notes.”

“But no eighth rests?” Glimmer asked.

“No rest for the weary,” He said. “Not even short ones.”

Glimmer laughed.

“How are you feeling about a coffee run?” Bow asked.

“I’m good, thank you,” Glimmer said. Bow stared at her for a long moment. “What?”

“You don’t want coffee? Are you feeling alright?”

“I feel fine,” She said. “I just- well, there’s a reason why Perfuma doesn’t drink coffee, and I’m trying to, you know…” She put a hand to her throat. “Keep the voice healthy.”

Bow smiled. “Look at you, Glimmer!”

“It’s not a big deal,” She said. “I’m just trying to- you know, be a leading lady.”

“I’m so proud of you,” Bow said. “My leading lady.”

Glimmer blushed and handed him her keys. “Here, you can take my car to the coffee house.”

“I don’t drink coffee,” he reminded her. “Which means I can stay with you.”

“But- but your chai- Bow, do you get coffee just because I do?”

“Mostly,” He said. “I mean, don’t get me wrong, I love a dirty chai-“

“Bow, how many times have we gotten coffee?” She asked. “And you never told me that you only went for my sake?”

“I thought you knew,” He said, shrugging.

“And just now, were you going to go to the coffeehouse just to get me my afternoon coffee?”

Bow nodded. Glimmer was surprised when she smiled, she normally would have rolled her eyes.

“Here, let me run lines with you,” Bow said, reaching for her script.

“No, we have forty minutes before rehearsal, and you need a

break, so let's take a break. We can take a walk around the tennis courts."

“Are you sure? The first act is supposed to be off-book today.” He reminded her. She nodded her head.

“We ran lines at lunch, remember? We know the first act. And taking a little break from all the music in your brain will be good for you.”

Bow thought for a moment, then smiled.

“Glimmer, what would I do without you?” He asked.

“That’s a very good question,” She said. “So it’s lucky I’m not going anywhere."

Bow smiled. "C'mon, let's take a walk."

Chapter End Notes

hi besties!

I love cliches. can y'all tell I love cliches? stage kisses are the theatre kid (derogatory) equivalent of "there was only one bed."

can you also tell that I've sat through a lot of classes about vocal health? until I went to college, I didn't drink any caffeine at all. here we are, a truly indiscernible about of time

later, and sugar free Red Bulls are a staple in my fridge. so far, my voice hasn't complained much.

wow, thank you for all of your kind words last chapter! I can't tell you how much they mean to me. sorry this one is a little shorter- I changed a few things about my outline. honestly, why do I even make outlines? life is improvised, and I went to improv camp for three summers.

we started rehearsals for our opera scenes program this week, and I went to Starbucks today. it's totally freezing here- absolute soup and/or cocoa weather. what is everyone else up to this week? is anyone else cold?

anyway, please leave comments and kudos if you feel so moved, I truly love hearing from all of you.

Love,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Apparently, Cinderella originally killed her mom by accident," Glimmer told Adora. "Isn't that wild?"

"Wait, really? Cinderella murdered her mom?"

"Not on purpose- her stepmother tricked her into it."

"Does Mermista know this?"

"I haven't told her yet, but this definitely makes her theory about how my papa died more plausible."

Adora laughed and leaned back, soaking in the afternoon sun. They were sitting on the bed of Adora's truck, trying to enjoy what would probably be their last somewhat warm day before Autumn fully set in.

"I talked to Catra on Monday," Adora said after a moment.

"Oh? Well, that's good, Adora. Right?" Glimmer said.

"Wrong," Adora said honestly. "But I think she might be the reason the living room set collapsed."

"Huh?" Glimmer asked, raising an eyebrow. "Why do you think that?"

"Just…the way she was talking. She got all angry with me and then asked if I had gotten the set fixed…" Adora glared at the far end of the parking lot. "She thinks she's so smart, but I'm on to her."

"You're on to her?" Glimmer asked, raising her eyebrows. "How so?"

"I know she's up to something, and I'm going to find out what it is," Adora said. "She'll never expect it, because she thinks that she's smarter than I am."

"Adora, I'm sure she's not planning anything-"

"That's great, Glimmer, pretend we don't know anything. Keep her in the dark as much as we can."

Glimmer considered arguing- she seriously doubted that Catra was sabotaging Adora's sets or the show in any way, but she also knew that Adora was not reasonable when it came to Catra, so she let the subject drop.

“Will you run lines with me?” She asked after a moment. “I keep messing up this scene.”

“Sure,” Adora said, taking her script. “Where do you want me to start?”

“‘Well, your majesty, I think I’d remember meeting the prince,’” Glimmer recited.

“‘Ah, well- would you care to dance?’”

“Adora, that’s not much of a cue,” Glimmer informed her. “Can’t you try and read it like Bow would?”

“Like- like lower my voice?”

“It’s not just about that- it’s…” She wrinkled her nose, concentrating. “It’s about the inflection.”

“Then why aren’t you running lines with him?” Adora asked.

“Because he’s running his solos with Netossa since he won't have a chance to before we run the second act tomorrow in full, and

now is probably the best time anyway since Spinnerella has to leave by five, which is why we're doing our costume fittings today-"

"Glimmer," Adora said, closing her script and putting her hand over Glimmer's. "You're obsessed."

"I'm not obsessed," She said, wrinkling her nose. "I'm just… dedicated. I'm trying to be a leading lady."

"Alright, princess," Adora said. "Have you seen either of your costumes yet?"

"We have the first act costume figured out, since it's just a skirt and a blouse and an apron," She said. "But we're seeing about the ballgown from Bright Moon Community College, since, you know, believe it or not, there isn't a wide variety of ballgowns in our costume storage."

"I've seen our costumes, I can believe that." Adora said. "So you haven't seen it at all?"

"Nope," Glimmer said. "But that kind of makes it more exciting, you know? Like…this is the ballgown. This is the Cinderella dress, and I finally get to see it, you know?"

“Sure,” Adora said. “We should get inside, then, I have a little painting to finish up.”

Glimmer checked her watch. “Shoot, you’re right. I’ll show you the dress before I leave, okay?”

“Sounds good, Princess,” Adora said, taking Glimmer's hand and helping her off the bed of her truck.

oOo

Bow pulled off his jacket- whoever had played Christopher in Bright Moon Community College’s production of Cinderella must have had smaller arms than he did. Other than that, he and a few members of the costume crew had managed to piece together a set of costumes for Prince Christopher.

Now he was sitting on the stage, absentmindedly looking over his lines. He had seen almost everyone in the cast milling in and out of the dressing rooms, but he hadn’t seen Glimmer yet, and he had been so sure that she would show him her ballgown. Ten minutes ago, he had sent her a text asking where she was, to which she had not responded.

He checked his watch, then decided to find Glimmer himself.

When he left the auditorium, he saw Mermista standing outside of the dressing room, wearing her (potential) costume.

“Hey, Bow,” she said.

“Hi, Mermista. Have you seen Glimmer?”

“She left a little bit ago,” Mermista said.

“Huh,” Bow said. “She didn’t show me her dress before she left.”

Mermista shrugged. “Do you need a ride home?”

“No, I’m pretty sure Adora is still here, I’ll ask her. Thanks though, Mermista.”

Adora was still in the workroom when Bow went to go find her.

“Actually, would you mind running me to Glimmer’s?” He asked when she offered to drive him back to his house.

“Sure,” Adora said. “Is everything okay?"

“I think so,” Bow said, holding the school doors open for Adora. “She left without showing me her costume.”

“That’s not like her," Adora said.

“I know,” Bow agreed. “How is the set going?”

“It's just about finished," She said as they drove away from the school and towards Glimmer's neighborhood. "The shop classes and the rest of the set crew have been really helpful.”

“No other mishaps?"

Adora shook her head. “Glimmer knows you're coming, right?"

Bow nodded his head. "I texted her a little bit ago, she said the front door will be unlocked.”

“And you’ll tell me if something’s wrong?”

“Of course," He said. "I'm sure she's fine, though. Right?”

“Right,” Adora said, stopping in Glimmer's driveway.

Bow thanked Adora before he walked up to Glimmer's house. Surely enough, the front door was unlocked.

Bow loved Glimmer’s house and had had its layout memorized since he was seven years old. The front door led into the living room, the only room between the kitchen and her mom’s home office. A few feet away from the front door stood the staircase. Glimmer's bedroom door was the first on the left. The door in question was just slightly ajar.

“Can I come in?" He asked.

“Go ahead,” Glimmer said. When Bow pushed the door open, he saw Glimmer on her bed, enveloped in her favorite plushy pink blanket. Miette was watching her with mild interest.

“Hi, Miette,” Bow said, scooping her into his arms. “Who’s a pretty kitty? How’s my sweet girl?”

“Stop smothering Miette,” Glimmer griped from beneath her blanket. Bow quickly kissed the top of Miette’s head and set her back on the floor before sitting beside Glimmer on her bed.

“So...how’s my sweet girl?” He asked the blanket.

“They’re going to laugh at me,” Glimmer said. “And I’m going to look stupid.”

“Neither of those things are going to happen- have you read the script? Cinderella isn’t very funny.”

“That’s not what I meant and you know it,” She said, poking her head out of her cocoon.

“Well, you won’t look stupid, either,” Bow said. “What happened, Glimmer?”

“I tried on the stupid ballgown,” She said. “And it was like, eight inches too long and four sizes too small.”

“Are you upset that it didn’t fit?” He asked. “That’s not like you.”

“I could care less about it fitting- sometimes dresses don’t fit. That’s how clothes work. It’s that it would have fit Perfuma perfectly, and she would have looked amazing in it.”

“I don’t think I understand,” Bow said.

“It was supposed to be Perfuma, Bow,” She said, sitting up and out of her blanket. “She was supposed to play Cinderella. I’m

here...I’m here on accident.”

“Glimmer,” Bow sighed.

“Maybe I…maybe I don’t deserve my role. Maybe I shouldn’t be Cinderella at all. Maybe it doesn't matter how hard I practice, or how much Cinderella history I learn, I'm never going to deserve her."

“Glimmer, they chose you for a reason,” He reminded her. “And you’re doing really, really well. Perfuma was just talking about it, she says that she’s never heard you sing so well.”

Glimmer shrugged her shoulders.

“Hey,” he said, putting his hand on her knee. “I also think you’re doing really well.”

She looked over and him and almost smiled.

“Really?” She asked.

“Really,” he said. “Come on, Glimmer. You never doubt yourself, why should you start now over a stupid dress?”

“It was a stupid dress,” She conceded. “It had these puffed sleeves- and look, there’s still glitter on me.”

She showed him her sparkling hands. Bow laughed.

"You live up to your name," He said. This time, Glimmer smiled fully.

"What do we do about the dress, though? We're supposed to be doing full run-throughs soon."

He furrowed his brow. "Do you have anything that might work?"

She shook her head, her smile falling. "Not really."

"Maybe we can get one secondhand?"

Glimmer thought for a moment.

"What if we don't find anything?" She asked.

"We'll cross that bridge when we come to it," He said, taking hold of her hand. "We have two weeks, still. We'll figure something out."

Glimmer squeezed his hand. "You're the best, Bow. I don't know what I would do without you."

“Maybe you can take me to my house? Now that I know you're okay, I feel like I should start my homework."

She smiled. “Of course, your carriage awaits.”

oOo

When Glimmer reached her house again, her mom was carrying groceries into the house. Glimmer parked her car and gathered the remaining bags in her arms before taking them inside.

“Thank you, dear,” Angella said, setting her bags on the kitchen counter. “Aren’t you supposed to be at rehearsal?”

“Today was costume fittings,” Glimmer explained.

“Ah, you mentioned that,” Angella said. “Do you like your costumes?”

“I like the first one,” She said. “But the ballgown didn’t fit. Like, at all.”

“Oh, I see.” Angella said. “But you open in two weeks.”

“I know,” Glimmer said, frowning again. “Bow and I were thinking about looking at some thrift stores, but that’s still kind of risky.”

“I see,” Angella said, then thought for a moment longer. “Actually, you know Juliet, who I work with?”

“Yeah, vaguely,” Glimmer said.

“She was talking about wanting to get rid of her wedding dress just this morning.” Angella said. “Maybe that could be your Cinderella gown?”

“A wedding dress?” Glimmer asked. “I don’t know if that’s going to look very Cinderella-y.”

“I don’t remember it looking like a wedding dress, it wasn’t even white,” Angella said. “It was more pink than anything- here, I’ll find you a picture.”

“Do you think it would fit?” Glimmer asked while Angella scrolled through her camera roll to find a photo from years ago.

“Juliet mentioned it was too small for her, now, so it might fit you,” Angella said. “Ah, here it is.”

She showed Glimmer the picture. It was a lovely dress, certainly less wedding-ish than Glimmer had expected. It was a ballgown made of blush tulle, with a sweetheart neckline and off-the-shoulder sleeves. Glimmer imagined it with her elbow-length gloves and a tiara- it was just about perfect for Cinderella.

“It’s lovely,” She said. “Would Juliet let me borrow it?”

“She said it was just taking up room in her closet,” She said. “I’ll tell you what, I’ll ask Juliet if she can bring it to the office tomorrow.”

“Alright, mom. Thank you,” She said. Angella smiled.

“Don't mention it,” She said. “Now, don’t you have homework to do?”

“A little,” Glimmer admitted.

“Are you off-book?” She asked, raising an eyebrow.

“Yes, mom,” She answered. “Well, mostly. I should look over the second act.”

“Alright, my darling,” She said. “I have a few things to get done, but I’ll ask Juliet about her dress, alright?”

“Thanks mom,” Glimmer said, watching her mom leave the kitchen.

oOo

Bow was relieved to see Glimmer in much better spirits the next day. She was glowing with anticipation when she told him about the dress that her mom thought would work for Cinderella.

“It’s a lot of tulle, which means it might be a little less danceable, and I’m still worried about it being short on me, and that’s even if it fits,” She was saying after school. “But I still think-“ her phone chimed in her hand.

“Big news?” He asked as she read her text.

“Mom just texted me, she dropped off Juliet’s dress this afternoon!” She said, grinning. “So it’s ready for me to try on!”

“Then lead the way, princess,” He said. “If we shake a leg, we should have time to run to the house and try it on before rehearsal.”

“Bow, you’re the best!” She cried, hugging him tightly.

“Here, let me drive,” He said.

Surely enough, Juliet’s wedding dress was hanging on Glimmer’s bedroom doorframe when they came into the house.

“Oh, it’s beautiful,” Glimmer breathed. “I’ll hurry, I promise.”

The door closed behind her, and for a moment, Bow waited in the hallway.

“Bow?” Glimmer called from her bedroom. “A little help?”

Bow pushed the door open and stepped inside, where Glimmer was waiting.

“Zip me up, would you?” She asked. “This is far up as I could get it.” Bow nodded his head and took the zipper in his hands.

Her skin was soft- why did that take him by surprise? His skin had touched Glimmer’s millions of times. They hugged, they high-fived, they held hands- this wasn’t even the first time he had touched her back- they had rubbed tension out of one another’s shoulders, he had scratched her back and helped her put on sunscreen…

But this seemed…different, and he found himself shaking himself out of a trance as the zipper reached the top of her back.

"I think there's a hook and eye, too," She said. His fingers pressed against the flesh of her back while he fumbled with the tiny silver clasp.

"Do you like this one?" She asked, smoothing out the wrinkles on the satin skirt.

Glimmer had a lovelock at the nape of her neck- how had he never noticed it before?

"Bow?"

He blinked and looked at her, and immediately smiled.

It wasn't quite her trademark shade of pink- it was much lighter, almost a blush, but that made her seem…softer. Almost angelic. Her rounded shoulders peeked out from the wispy, off-the-shoulder sleeves, and the bodice hugged her waist and chest just enough. The skirt was filled out by layers of tulle, so many that on anyone else, it would have seemed ostentatious. On Glimmer, somehow it worked beautifully. While it would have been tea-length on Juliet, the hem barely brushed the bottom of Glimmer's shoes.

The dress was a miracle.

Glimmer was a miracle.

"Do you like it?" She asked almost anxiously, looking at him with wide eyes. "I mean, we can keep looking, because obviously it's a little-"

"Glimmer," He said, finally finding his voice. "This is the dress. You're Cinderella in this dress."

Relief flooded her face. "Really?"

"Absolutely."

"Oh," She said, and smiled that smile again. What had he said to make her smile like that? Should he keep saying it?

He wanted to keep saying it, if only to keep her smiling.

"I love it," Glimmer said earnestly.

"I do too," Bow said.

“Well, as long as the prince approves, I think we’ve found our stupid dress.”

“Easy enough,” He said. “I’ll meet you back in the kitchen, okay? Whenever you’re-“

“Bow, actually, would you mind unzipping me?”

Bow nodded his head as she turned her back towards him. There was that lock of hair again.

He unclasped the hook and eye and guided the zipper down her back.

“Thanks,” She said.

“No problem,” He said, trying to keep the confusion he felt out of his voice. Glimmer had a freckle on her right shoulder blade- how had he never noticed it before?

“I’ll be right out,” Glimmer said, taking the dress’s hanger off of the bed. Bow nodded his head and left her to get dressed, his vision still clouded by the sight of her.

Chapter End Notes

hi besties! how is everyone? here is some ~physical tension~ for all your physical tension needs.

the Cinderella lore at the beginning comes from my dear friend Tippenfunkaport, who graced me with her knowledge earlier this week. rest assured, I will never view Cinderella the same way ever again.

again, sorry this chapter is a little shorter than the first three- rest assured, there are BIG things coming, especially since opening night is just over the horizon!

anyway, I love you all. does anyone have weekend plans?

as always, I am available on Tumblr @somebodysmuse, and please, please, please leave comments or Kudos if you feel so moved. y'all never fail to make my day.

Love,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Alright, I'll have the dress unzipped and ready for you to step into," Adora said, handing Glimmer her blouse. Netossa was running trouble spots in the opening ensemble number, giving Adora and Glimmer time to practice her quick change into her ballgown.

"I don't know if that will shave a whole 12 seconds off of our time, though," Glimmer said worriedly, looking at the stopwatch on her phone. Spinerella had told her that she and Adora would have 30 seconds for her to get changed and back onstage. Since everyone else was going to be either onstage or preparing for the second act, the task of getting Glimmer undressed and dressed again fell to Adora. "But I can be faster getting my skirt off."

"Alright, and I'll have the tiara ready to go, too." She said. "And don't worry about picking anything up, I can take care of that."

"My mother would have a fit if she heard you saying that," Glimmer informed her, tying her bandana around her head again. "Okay, one more time? I think we've got it this time."

"I'm ready," Adora said. "Go back onstage and come back here, I'll start the timer."

Glimmer ran onstage and back offstage, meeting Adora in the wings. The next 30 seconds were a blur of fabric and zippers and taking Adora's hand while she stepped into her shoes and struggling to pull her gloves on.

"What's our time?" She asked, straightening her tiara.

"30.2 seconds!" Adora cried victoriously, throwing her fist in the air.

"Oh, thank goodness!" Glimmer breathed. "All we have to do is exactly what we did every night."

"And we have until Friday to practice," Adora said. "We'll have it down to a science by opening night."

"I hope so," Glimmer said. "We only have four more rehearsals until final dress- I can't believe it's almost tech week."

"But you're ready," Adora said. "At least, the sets are."

"That's true, and they look lovely," Glimmer said. "But…yeah, I guess we're ready. God, I hope so."

Adora picked up Glimmer's dress and started to put it back on its hanger. "I think you are."

Glimmer pulled on her leggings, which had been sitting in a pile with her crewneck since she and Adora had gotten backstage.

"Is that everything?" She asked, looking around backstage once she was dressed.

"Do you have the tiara?" Adora asked. Glimmer held it up. "Then we're good to go!"

"Are you sure you can't come to Bow's tonight?" Glimmer asked as they walked down the hallway towards the choir room. "It's been forever since we've had a sleepover."

"I would if I could," Adora said. "But Lonnie invited me over, and I can't bail on her again."

"Alright," Glimmer sighed. "Well, if you get finished early, you should come by."

"I will," Adora said. "Why are you staying at Bow's, anyway? You stay at home while your mom is on business all the time."

"She's going away overnight, and she'll be all the way in the Crimson Waste, so she wants me to be with, you know, a 'responsible' adult."

“Well, she knows that Bow’s Dads won’t let you starve,” Adora said.

“Oh, she does. Lance let her know that he would be making a roast.”

“That’s- wait…” Adora stopped in her tracks.

“Is everything o- oh,” Glimmer said, seeing Catra walking out of the workroom.

“Hey, Adora,” Catra said, her gaze flicking towards her before settling on Glimmer. “Can you come to the sound booth, Cinderella? Entrapta wants to figure out which mic you should use.”

“I- sure,” Glimmer said. “Of course.”

“Why were you in the workroom?” Adora asked. Catra raised an eyebrow, maddeningly blasé, like always.

“I was looking for Cinderella, Adora,” She explained. “Didn’t you hear that Entrapta wants to talk to her?”

Adora’s brow furrowed, and it stayed furrowed as Glimmer walked down the hallway to the auditorium with Catra.

Glimmer looked back. Catra did not.

oOo

“Bow, honey, will you show me where on the school website I can buy tickets?”

“Yes, Dad,” Bow said.

“Don’t you work with online databases every day?” George asked from his armchair.

“I work with the same databases that you do, and they're a lot easier to use than the school website.”

“Dad’s got a point, Dad,” Bow said. “The school website hasn’t been updated since Melody graduated.”

“How is Melody, by the way?” Glimmer asked, looking up from the card game she and Bow had been playing on the sofa.

“She’s actually rehearsing for a show, as well,” George answered. “We’re planning on visiting her for opening night in about a month.”

“That’s exciting,” Glimmer said.

“Is she still seeing the- uh, what was his name? The leading tenor?” Bow asked, still navigating their school’s outdated website.

“She hasn’t said otherwise,” Lance said.

“She’s dating one of her castmates?” Glimmer asked.

“She’s seeing him,” Lance clarified. “As far as we know, it’s nothing serious.”

“Do you only need two tickets?” Bow asked.

“Just the two,” George said.

“For opening night?”

“That’s right,” George said. “Thank you, baby.”

Bow handed his Dad his laptop and went to join Glimmer again. “Did you look at my cards?” He asked.

“Absolutely not," She answered. “I don’t need to, I’m already winning.”

George laughed. “Good one, sweetheart.”

“She’s not winning,” Bow informed his Dads. “Not by that much.”

“I still believe in you,” Lance told his son. “I have the utmost faith.”

Glimmer smiled and marveled, not for the first time, at just how great Bow's Dads were. Obviously Lance could be a hardass and George could be overbearing (he had tried to teach both Bow and Glimmer how to drive at the start of last summer- his tutelage lasted one afternoon until Lance swooped in, fearing his husband would go into cardiac arrest for all the stress he was feeling), but still, they had held her hand throughout her entire childhood, especially after her own father passed away.

Their grandfather clock chimed, and both of his Dads looked towards it, checking the time.

“Goodness, it’s getting late,” George said. “We should get to bed, love. The pullout couch is fixed now, Glimmer, so it should be easier to assemble now."

“Don't stay up too late, you two,” Lance told Bow and Glimmer as he stood. “You’ll both want to be well-rested for tech week.”

“Yes, Dads,” Bow said.

“Yes, Dads,” Glimmer echoed. Both George and Lance laughed.

“Goodnight, you two,” George said. “Glimmer, sweetheart, you know where the blankets are, right?”

“I know,” She said. “Thank you.”

George leaned over the back of the sofa and kissed the top of Bow’s head, then the top of Glimmers, before leaving the room.

“Can you believe tech week starts on Monday?” Glimmer asked, setting down her cards. “It feels like we had auditions yesterday.”

“Time flies when you're having fun,” Bow said.

“It’s really coming together," She said. “I can’t believe we have an actual show, and without Perfuma or Sea Hawk. It’s like a real life

Cinderella story!”

Bow smiled. Glimmer rested her head against his shoulder.

“I don’t think I’ve said so yet, Bow,” She said softly, nuzzling against his neck. “But this has been…so fun. And so wonderful. I’m so glad they chose us.”

“They chose *you*,” Bow said.

Glimmer sat up, surprised at his tone, and even more surprise that he looked almost…sad.

“What do you mean?” She asked. “They chose everyone, Bow.”

“No, they chose you, and they chose Perfuma, and they chose Frosta and Mermista and Scorpia. They chose *everyone* but me.”

“But they did choose you,” She said softly.

“No, they settled for me because Sea Hawk couldn’t do the show,” he said. “I was no one’s first choice. I know that as well as anyone.”

Glimmer watched Bow for a long moment. He didn't raise his head or take his eyes off the ground while she looked at him. It was almost scary to see him looking so defeated- during the last few weeks, he had danced and sang and acted through hours of rehearsals, and no one would have known that he was feeling inferior.

She slid off of the sofa and knelt before him. Now he *had* to look at her instead of at the ground.

"You don't have to be Sea Hawk, Bow," Glimmer said. "The Christopher that you find, and that you perform, is supposed to be different from his because- well, you're you. You're Bow."

"I guess so," He said, sounding unconvinced.

"Do you want to know something?" She asked. Bow nodded his head. "I like your Christopher. I see why Cinderella falls in love with him."

"Really?" He asked. Glimmer nodded her head.

"I think he's funny, and smart, and so talented," She said. "To say nothing of handsome and kind."

"Well, shucks," He said, finally cracking a tiny smile. "There's no need to flatter me."

“I’m not flattering you,” She said. “I’m being honest. You’re my first choice, Bow.”

Bow looked up at her, his eyes finally meeting hers. Glimmer’s breath caught in her chest.

“I am?” He asked. She nodded her head.

“You’re going to be…just lovely,” She said, finally finding her voice. “I mean, we’ve done almost all we can do, after all.”

“Almost?” He asked.

“Well, we messed up the waltz during rehearsal today, but we can’t really practice that here,” She said. Bow looked at her for a moment before standing.

“Here, help me move the sofa,” Bow said, taking her hands and helping her stand.

“Really?” Glimmer asked.

“We’ve been running lines all day, I think we’ve earned a break,” Bow said.

Together, they pushed the sofa towards the breakfast nook, creating an empty space.

“Netossa is going to be very proud of us,” Glimmer said while Bow scrolled through the songs of the Cinderella Broadway cast recording, looking for the waltz. As soon as the music started playing, Bow took Glimmer’s hand and lead her to the center of their makeshift dance floor.

He put his hand on her waist, then pulled her, just slightly, closer to him. She wasn't sure if he would be able to hold her so closely if she were wearing the ballgown, but something kept her from telling him so.

Bow squeezed her hand three times, pulsating to the beat of the waltz.

Glimmer looked up at him, and they took their first step. She had never appreciated just how pretty the underscoring of their waltz was. It was…easier.

As much as she loved dancing with Prince Christopher, she absolutely preferred dancing with Bow.

And the thought of this being the last time that she got to dance with him made her indescribably sad.

Then Bow brought her closer. Glimmer looked up at him, her violet eyes piercing his.

And that feeling that had been growing in her chest spread from the top of her head to the soles of her shoes until her entire being was struck with a blinding, life-altering realization.

She wanted to keep dancing with Bow.

She *loved* Bow.

Chapter End Notes

HI BESTIES HOW ARE WE

I am currently letting this hair mask sit (is anyone else's hair really dry because of the cold?) and decided to send a little extra ~yearning~ your way, just in time for tech week!

anyway, as always, please please please leave kudos and comments if you feel so inclined, it warms my heart immensely to hear from all of you. have a good week! I'll see you very soon.

Love,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 6

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Glimmer hummed the tune to the Cinderella overture as she got ready for rehearsal on Monday. Tech week meant that rehearsals were held in the evenings instead of right after school to give the cast an idea of how the actual shows would feel.

Dreamily, she wrote “Are you the sweet invention of a lover’s dream? Or are you really as beautiful as you seem?” on her mirror with a dry-erase marker. In an hour, she would be wearing her microphone, and fully in costume, ready to run Cinderella for an imaginary audience.

The memory of Bow looking at her while they danced around his living room was still waltzing around her memory, casting her entire existence in a warm glow.

Now it was almost impossible to even look at Bow without considering all the doors that would open for her if he felt the same way about her. Would his arms feel different around her? Would he kiss her forehead?

Oh, kissing Bow…

Actually kissing Bow...

On the flip side, she had to wonder what would happen if Bow didn't feel the same way for her? Of course she couldn't tell him how she felt, what would that do to their friendship?

But the way he had looked at her that night…

She and Bow had always been close with one another. They held hands, they snuggled on their sofas, and she could remember more than one instance of waking up on Bow's chest, his arm around her waist as he slept on.

Had Bow been flirting with her all these years?

Had she been flirting back?

She glanced down at her phone, unless she hurried, she was going to be late to rehearsal. She grabbed her curling iron, makeup bag, and her ballet flats and shoved them all in her tote bag.

When she went downstairs, she saw a canned iced coffee sitting on her kitchen counter with a note

Working late tonight, here's a little extra energy for tech week.

Love,

Mom

She looked down at the tiny can of coffee and thought about Bow, who didn't drink coffee, who was willing to go and get her a coffee just because she wanted one. She sighed and put the coffee in her bag.

She would just have to play everything with Bow by ear- if he gave her any reason to believe that he liked her, she would tell him how she felt.

But if he didn't…

She shook her head- that was a possibility that she couldn't bear to confront.

oOo

"Can I use your blush?" Mermista asked Glimmer at rehearsal.

"Go ahead," Glimmer said, pinning her bandana into her curls. Her eyes trailed towards Frosta, struggling to lift the back of her dress over her mic belt.

“Here, can I help you?” She asked, walking to Frosta.

“Please,” She said. “I think it’s caught on something.”

Glimmer moved her mic to the side and buttoned her dress. “Does that feel alright?”

Frosta nodded. “Thanks, Glimmer.”

There was a knock on the dressing room door.

“Is everyone decent?” Bow said from outside. Glimmer’s stomach did a tiny flip at the sound- would she ever get used to that?

“Not yet!” Glimmer called back.

“Glimmer, do you have time to do my brows?”

Glimmer grabbed her apron and a brow gel from her tabletop and left the dressing room.

“Who told you you needed your brows done?” She asked. “And do you have a brow pencil? Mine definitely isn’t going to work on

your brows.”

“Netossa said on Saturday that my expressions would stand out more if they were a little stronger,” He said, handing her a brow pencil. “Melody left this at the house.”

“We need to get you a new one, then,” Glimmer said. “Here, sit down for me.”

She knelt in front of Bow on the old carpeted hallway. He looked absolutely beautiful underneath the flickering lights.

“Alright, relax your brows for me.”

She took his chin in her hands to stabilize his head, then carefully outlined the bottom arches of his eyebrows.

“You have beautiful brows," She said before she could stop herself.

“Oh?” Bow asked, raising a (beautiful) eyebrow.

“You do,” she said. “I’m almost tempted to forgive you for not keeping them still.”

Once she had finished penciling in his brows, she took her brow gel and went over her work.

“I thought your pencil wouldn’t work on my brows?” He asked.

“This is a brow gel, it’s clear,” Glimmer explained. “Bow, you’ve seen me do my brows, you know that.”

“I don’t normally watch your products,” He said.

“That’s your boy brain at work," She chided gently. “Though I doubt Adora could pick a brow gel out of my makeup bag.”

Bow laughed.

“It was lonely driving here without you,” Bow said after a moment. Glimmer smiled, just slightly.

“Oh? You don’t prefer George’s station wagon?” She asked, trying to keep her voice light.

“It’s too quiet,” He said. “I mean, I understand that you’re called half an hour before me for makeup and stuff, but it’s still…

different without you.”

The auditorium door opened and Netossa stepped into the hallway.

“One minute to places, you two,” She said.

“Thank you, one,” They answered in unison.

“Here, let me,” Bow said, taking her hand and helping her stand once Netossa went back into the auditorium. “Thanks for doing my brows.”

“There wasn’t much to do,” Glimmer said. Had Bow always been this tall? Had she always had to look up at him to meet his eyes?

“I’ll see you out there,” He said. “I should get to places.”

“Okay,” She answered. “See you out there.”

oOo

The next day, Glimmer came to dress rehearsal and got into costume. After getting her mic checked, she walked out of the auditorium and towards the bathroom.

To her surprise, Perfuma was sitting on the floor of the bathroom, slumped over on her backpack and fast asleep.

“Perfuma?” Glimmer asked, kneeling beside her. Perfuma didn’t stir. “Hey, Perfuma? Perfuma, wake up!”

Glimmer gently shook her shoulder and Perfuma bolted upwards, one of her false eyelashes coming unglued from her lid.

“What? Huh?” She asked, blinking blearily. “What’s going on?”

“Nothing,” Glimmer said. “It’s just almost time for places, I thought you would want to know.”

“Oh,” She said, pulling off her eyelash. “Right, thank you…”

“Are you feeling alright?” Glimmer asked. “Are you getting sick?”

Perfuma did look a little pale, and her face looked a little more hollow, to say nothing of the bags that were forming under her eyes.

“No,” She said. “No, I feel fine.”

“Are you sure?” She asked.

Perfuma nodded. “I just…no, I’m okay. I just got back from the opera house, and the guy who plays Tamino is acting like such a tool, and…” She sighed and rested her head in her hands, leaning forward onto her elbows. “I’m just so tired, Glimmer. I’m exhausted.”

Glimmer was shocked when Perfuma’s shoulders started to shake with a series of heaving, exhausted sobs. Once she gathered her senses, she gently put her hand on Perfuma’s shoulder.

“I’ll be right back, okay?” She asked. Perfuma nodded her head, keeping her face covered. Glimmer hiked up her skirt and bolted from the hallway to the auditorium, finding Netossa and Spinnerella in the back row.

“Glimmer, it’s almost places,” Netossa said.

“I know,” She said. “So can we please, please, please delay starting? Just for a little while?”

“Is something wrong?” Spinnerella asked.

“Perfuma is…she just need a little longer,” She said. “So can we pretty please wait?”

“Should I go talk to her?” Spinnerella asked.

“No, no,” Glimmer said. “I don’t think she wants to make a big deal out of it.”

Netossa nodded her head. “How long do you need?”

“Maybe twenty minutes?” Glimmer asked.

“Alright,” Netossa said. “Twenty minutes.”

“Thank you, twenty,” Glimmer said, then ran out of the auditorium to the dressing room, looking for a tiny can at the bottom of her tote bag. She was short of breath by the time she made it back to Perfuma, who was crying even harder, in the bathroom.

“I don’t have time to do this,” she said, forcing her head up, her tears streaking her mascara and leaving runny, black trails through her foundation. “We have to be onstage soon, and I start the entire show, and…”

“That’s not important,” Glimmer said. “I talked to Netossa and Spinnerella, we’re starting in twenty minutes.”

“Wait, what? Why?”

“Not important.” Glimmer said, then handed her the can. “Drink this.”

“What is it?”

“It’s iced coffee,”

“I don’t drink-“

“One coffee won’t kill you, or mutilate your vocal chords,” Glimmer said sternly. “And it will do you good to have your blood sugar up.”

Perfuma wiped her eyes.

“Shit, that is delicious,” She said after taking a small sip. “God, I see why people drink this all the time.”

Glimmer laughed.

"I feel so stupid," Perfuma said after a moment. "I thought…I thought that I could do this, you know? I thought I could be in two really big shows at once."

"You are doing two shows at once," Glimmer said. "And no one, other than me, would ever know that you're struggling."

"I'm not supposed to struggle," Perfuma said harshly. "I'm supposed to be able to do this."

"Anyone would struggle, Perfuma."

"I'm not anyone-"

"Okay, Perfuma, no offense, but you're not special." Glimmer said. "You are flesh and bone like the rest of us. And this is a perfectly normal reaction for someone who is rehearsing an opera and in tech week for a musical."

Perfuma wiped her eyes. "Really?"

Glimmer nodded her head. "Really."

Perfuma smiled. “Thanks, Glimmer. I’m…I’m sorry about all of this.”

“Don't be,” Glimmer said. “You would do the same for me, right?”

Perfuma nodded her head. “Of course.”

“So there’s nothing to be sorry for. We’re castmates, Perfuma. We’re supposed to help one another.”

Perfuma took a deep breath and rested her head against Glimmer’s shoulder. They sat on the floor for a moment while Perfuma nursed her iced coffee.

“How much time do we have?” Perfuma asked.

Glimmer checked the time. “We have ten minutes until places.”

Perfuma nodded her head and sat up. “Alright, I need to go fix my makeup and get into costume.”

Glimmer stood and offered Perfuma her hand, helping her stand. Perfuma managed a convincing smile.

“Alright,” she said. “Let’s go put on a show.”

oOo

“Mermista, your reaction when Glimmer and Bow are married at the end was hilarious, keep doing that,” Spinnerella said, looking down at the yellow memo pad where she had been writing her notes throughout rehearsal.

“Gotcha, I’ll keep being disgusted.” Mermista said.

The cast laughed- that had been a trend all during final dress rehearsal. Everyone, Netossa and Spinnerella included, was in high spirits, glowing with anticipation for opening night.

“Alright, those are all of my notes,” Spinnerella said. “Tossa, darling, do you have any notes?”

“Everyone remember to grab your show tee shirt from the choir room if you haven’t yet,” Netossa said. “And remember to wear them tomorrow. You should all be so proud of yourselves.”

Glimmer smiled and leaned her head against Bow’s shoulder, feeling proud of her own work and for his. That night had been their best performance so far- she had remembered every line that she had dropped the previous night, Bow’s solo after the ball

had had her in tears backstage, and she felt like he had *looked* at her differently tonight. The way he looked at her made her feel like a princess.

That nagging little voice in the back of her head that was telling her that Bow would never feel the same way about her was much quieter.

"Entrapta wants those of you that have mics to be ready for mic checks at 6:45," Nestossa told the cast. "and we're going to do warmups at fifteen minutes to curtain. Everyone understand?"

A cast of fifteen heads nodded.

"Alright, everyone go home and get lots of rest. Drink lots of water, drink your hot tea. I'm proud of all of you." Netossa reached over and took hold of her wife's hand. "We both are. Now go home! Get lots of sleep!"

Bow stood and helped Glimmer off of the stage floor.

"Will you text me when you get home?" Glimmer asked.

"Of course," He said. "I'll see you tomorrow morning, okay?"

"Okay," Glimmer said. "Goodnight, Bow, drive safe."

Bow waved goodbye to her as she left the stage. Frosta joined her on the way out of the auditorium.

"You were so funny tonight," Glimmer told her. "I had to keep myself from laughing when you were reciting your poem."

"Really?" Frosta asked, her eyes wide.

"Oh, absolutely," Glimmer said, reaching into her bag to grab her keys. Instead of her keys, she found a pack of cinnamon gum, a lipstick, and her wallet. "Oh, dammit."

"What?" Frosta asked.

"I must have left my keys in the dressing room," She said. "I'll run in and grab them- I'll see you tomorrow, Frosta."

"Goodnight, Glimmer!" She called as Glimmer went back inside the school. Surely enough, her car keys were sitting in front of her mirror next to a roll of mic tape. As she walked down the hallway, she heard Bow's voice from the opened door to the auditorium, along with Perfuma's. She stopped a few feet from the door, hearing her name.

Was it really eavesdropping if they were talking about her?

"I have to admit, I had a few doubts at first, and especially after the dress didn't work for her- well, one way or another, Glimmer is doing so well. I couldn't be happier."

Glimmer felt her heart swelling at Perfuma's praise. If the Resident Ingenue thought she was doing well, that had to mean something.

"I'm really proud of her," She heard Bow say. He sounded proud of her, both fond and proud. She felt herself smile.

"And I'm sure you never doubted her for a second," Perfuma said.

"Well, Glimmer has never been one to shy away from things that scare her, or even things she's not supposed to do."

Glimmer furrowed her brow. Not supposed to do what? Not supposed to play Cinderella?

Perfuma seemed to be confused as well, because she asked her exact same question.

"I mean, it's Glimmer. She's not exactly who you'd expect to play Cinderella," Bow said.

Glimmer felt her heart drop to her chest- she wasn't sure how Perfuma responded because she turned and all but ran down the hallway to the parking lot. Her drive home was silent, all she could hear was Bow's words echoing in her head. She was vaguely aware of her feet carrying her through the garage, up the stairs, and into her bathroom.

Glimmer took a long look at herself in the mirror.

She's not who you'd expect to play Cinderella.

Bow had made it perfectly clear that he thought her singing was good enough to play Cinderella, and she had done so much work to find her character, to make her as real as possible when she delivered her lines. All that was left was...

She cringed, her heart dropping to her stomach as she remembered the reason why Prince Christopher even noticed Cinderella in the first place.

Bow didn't think she was pretty.

Her eyes filled with tears- if she had any doubts about how Bow felt about her, she was sure now. Bow loved her as a friend, not as…

She was so stupid. Somehow, over weeks of staring into Bow's eyes and seeing just how soft his expression was, and hearing him sing about loving her, and getting to feel his arms around her, and getting to feel his lips against hers…

Bow didn’t love her the way she loved him. Bow loved Cinderella- no, Prince Christopher loved Cinderella. But getting to see the way he pretended to love her hurt her heart even more.

She looked at the lyrics she had written on her bathroom mirror the week before. Bow didn’t even think she was beautiful, so how could he love her the way she loved him?

Maybe she should be grateful. If nothing else, she still got to experience some imitation of what it would be like to be loved by Bow, even if it was just pretend. Eventually, when he fell in love for real, she would have weeks worth of rehearsals to comfort her. As rotten of a consolation prize it was, it least she had gotten to pretend.

But Glimmer didn’t want to pretend! She wanted to kiss him for real, she wanted to hold his hand and move through the world alongside her beautiful best friend.

Glimmer grabbed a tissue and dried her cheeks.

Tomorrow night was opening night. Afterwards, she would have two more chances to pretend that Bow loved her. When the curtains closed, she would finally have to confront the truth.

She took her tissue and wiped the lyrics off of her mirror, unable to look at them any longer now that she knew the truth: the last few weeks had been a sweet invention of an unrequited lover’s dream.

And it was high time she stopped pretending. When the clock struck midnight on their final show, she, like Cinderella, would lose her gown, her glass slippers, and all the splendor of her fantasy.

But unlike Cinderella, her prince wouldn’t come back for her when the pretending stopped.

Chapter End Notes

do y'all like cliches? I love cliches. and I will never ever ever stop using them.

how is everyone? we're supposed to get a LOT of snow this week, so my classes were cancelled. if it's cold where you are, remember to get some cocoa and stay warm!

so as always, please please please leave comments and Kudos if you feel so moved! you are all lovely, and I hope things are so good for you.

Love,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 7

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Glimmer could barely look at Bow throughout the next day at school- it hurt to even hear his voice, how could she see him and know that he didn't…

So she kept their conversations to a minimum, making up some lame excuse about wanting to rest her voice for the show. Bow hadn't seemed very convinced, because he kept trying to get her to talk to him throughout the day. Luckily, she managed to escape talking to him at lunch, because Perfuma ran up to their table, holding a new edition of the Bright Moon Gazette.

"We had a critic in the audience last night," She said. "And they managed to sneak in a review of the school musical just before this week's edition was published!"

"What does it say?" Glimmer asked, unable to resist. She hadn't been paying much attention to her duties on the school newspaper since rehearsals started, and she had to know how her fellow journalists felt about her show.

"'Last night, I had the honor of watching the final dress rehearsal of Bright Moon High's *Cinderella*. As the lights lowered, I remembered the student body's reaction to the musical selection from almost two months ago and shared their feelings- what place did such an old show have on our stage?"

“No respect for the classics,” Bow said, shaking his head exaggeratedly.

“But as soon as the curtain rose, I found myself immediately swept away by the music, the costumes, and by the moving performances of our students. Both Cinderella and Prince Christopher breathed new life into a familiar story, and by the end, I found myself genuinely rooting for their well-deserved happily ever after. Rodgers and Hammerstein’s *Cinderella* is a Bright Moon High musical for the ages, and I highly recommend seeing it this weekend.’” Perfuma looked around the table, beaming. “Well, it sounds like we did pretty well!”

“I guess so,” Glimmer said, smiling.

“We had a well-deserved happily ever after,” Bow said, elbowing Glimmer. Her smile quickly fell.

“I guess so,” She said. “I’m going to get my own copy of the Gazette, I’m sure my mom will want to read the review.”

Glimmer left the table quickly, ignoring Bow’s worried glance her way.

“I told you everyone would love her,” Perfuma said pointedly to Bow.

“I didn’t doubt that!” Bow said.

“You’re doubting Glimmer?” Adora asked, leaning across the table. “That’s not like you.”

“That’s not what I said,” Bow said. “I just said that she’s a lot more, you know, fiery than Cinderella.”

“And I said that that’s where the acting comes in,” Perfuma said. “Last I checked, you weren’t born a prince, and I am nobody’s fairy godmother. There’s no one ‘type’ to play Cinderella, or any role, for that matter.”

“Alright, alright,” He said. “I know as much as anyone that Glimmer is a princess-“

“We know, we know,” Perfuma said. “Here, take this copy of the paper, I’ll grab another one when I pass the journalism room.”

Bow took the school paper from Perfuma and started flipping through the pages, his mind wandering towards Glimmer, where it stayed throughout the rest of the day. She didn’t even wait for him after school- he had to run to catch up with her on the way out the doors.

“Glimmer!” She heard him calling as she walked towards her car. She took a deep breath and forced a smile.

“Are we riding together to the show tonight?” He asked when he caught up to her. Glimmer felt her heart clench again.

“Sure,” She said, her voice strange and high. “If you want.”

“If I- Glimmer, is something wrong?” He asked.

Glimmer wanted to scream- of course something was wrong, but of course she couldn’t tell him, of course she couldn’t tell the one person she wanted to tell everything to that he was breaking her heart, and didn’t even know he was.

And how could she blame Bow? He hadn’t done anything wrong.

“I’m just nervous,” She said.

“I get that,” Bow said. “But you’ll be great, we’ve practiced so hard. We could do this show in our sleep.”

Glimmer cringed at the painful reminder that it was all pretend.

“I guess so,” She said, finally reaching her car. “I’ll see you tonight.”

oOo

"Alright, everyone take a deep breath," Netossa said. The entire cast and crew of Cinderella was standing in a circle in the choir room, just five minutes away from the curtain rising. "Now, envision your performance tonight. See yourself remembering every line and lyric- see a show that you can be proud of."

Adora took a deep breath. Even after years of pre-game huddles, she wasn't immune to pep talks. Neither was anyone in the cast, it seemed. Everyone was holding onto the hands of their fellow cast and cremates, their eyes tightly closed.

Even Catra seemed to be playing along- she was between Entrapta and Scorpia, dressed in a black tank top and black skinny jeans, her chest rising and falling with every deep breath.

Why was she playing along with all of this? Did she care about opening night going well?

Glimmer squeezed her hand. Adora glanced over to her and wondered, not for the first time that day, why she had been so quiet. Yesterday's rehearsal had been great, what had happened between last night and this morning?

"Alright," Netossa said. "I'm proud of all of you. Break legs, all of you. Entrapta, what's the time?"

“We are at places, people!” She said brightly.

“Thank you, places,” The cast replied, and the circle broke apart, scattering everyone around the backstage.

“Hey, break a leg," Glimmer told Adora.

“I- thanks, you too," She said. “Break both.”

Glimmer smiled- or tried to smile, and went backstage.

"Is she okay?” Adora asked Bow, who was re-taping his mic to his cheek.

“I don’t know," He said. “She’s been kinda quiet all day, and it’s starting to freak me out.”

“So she hasn't told you anything?”

“Not a word,” Bow said. “She barely even *looked* at me today.”

Bow’s eyes were downcast. Adora had never seen him looking so defeated.

He looked the way she had felt when Catra stopped talking to her.

“She's probably just nervous,” Adora said. “I’m sure it’s okay.”

“Places, you two!” Spinnerella reminded Bow and Adora as she walked past them.

“Break a leg, Bow,” Adora said.

“You two, Adora,” He said. “Though not literally- I know some of the set pieces are heavy.”

She heard a sharp laugh- she whirled around and saw Catra behind her. Before she could respond, she had left the green room for the sound booth.

Her heart rate was certainly elevated throughout the first act, the sound of Catra’s laughter still echoing in her brain.

But there was nothing to be anxious about so far- all of the set changes ran smoothly, and Catra, as far as she knew, was still in the sound booth with Entrapta.

The first act finale rolled around- Perfuma appeared before Glimmer, who was onstage in her rags and tatters, lamenting how she would never go to the ball. Glimmer *had* improved over the last few weeks.

Then she heard footsteps and saw Catra, just for a second, pass the opened door of the wings, then heard the door to the choir room open, then close.

“Oh, shit,” She breathed. “Shit…”

She glanced onstage, Perfuma was about to finish her verse, which meant she had no time to waste. She bolted from stage left, through the green room, and towards the dressing rooms. She looked around for one desperate second before her eyes finally landed on Bow.

“Bow, I need you to help Glimmer with her quick change,” She said, shoving the ballgown into his hands.

“I- what?” He asked.

“There’s not much time,” Adora said. “I just need to take care of something, okay? Everything else is back there, just go to stage left."

“I-“

“Now, Bow!” She said. “Go, Glimmer needs you! Run!"

Bow nodded his head and complied, still looking bewildered. Adora breathed a sigh of relief and followed Catra outside.

“Alright, what’s going on?” She demanded.

“I needed some air,” Catra said. “The hairspray in the atmosphere in there is enough to kill at canary.”

“Don’t try to mess with me, Catra,” Adora snapped. “That can’t happen anymore. You can ignore me, or fuck with me however you want, but I'm not going to let you ruin this show.”

“Excuse me?”

“I know you messed with the living room set,” Adora said. “That’s why you were acting so cryptic and why you got mad at me that day on the catwalk-“

“Adora, you’re delusional.”

“No, I’m just catching on to you,” Adora said. “I know that you’re not going to tell me anything outright anymore, because that's the exact same way I found out that you didn't want to be in my life anymore, even though you could have just told me!”

“If I wanted to- Adora, you’re so-“ Catra raked her fingers through her hair. “It’s incredible how wrong you are literally all the time.”

“What?”

“I didn’t want to stop being in your life, dummy!”

“Then why did you stop talking to me?” Adora asked. “Why didn’t you answer my texts? Why didn’t you call me back?”

“Because you were done with me, Adora! You had been moving closer and close to Cinderella and Prince Charming for so long, and I just thought that after you Scorpia’s party-“

“You keep saying Scorpia’s party like I remember anything that happened!” Adora said. “You know all I have are- are just- just these vague little- just pieces, Catra! You know I don’t remember!”

“You kissed me, Adora!” Catra’s voice broke when she said Adora’s name. “You…”

Catra's words hung between them for a long moment before she spoke again.

"I couldn't keep chasing you anymore. It hurt me too much. Not after…"

"After…" Adora's eyes widened. "Oh…"

The roof of Scorpia's pool house. The moon hanging above her and Catra, the summer breeze rippling through her curls. The taste of vodka and powdered lemonade on her mouth.

She was never drinking again.

"Catra," She sighed. "Catra, I can't- oh my God, Catra, I'm so-"

"Don't say you're sorry," Catra snapped. "It was so clearly a mistake, and you don't have to-"

"Catra, no it- I wanted- the only reason why I kissed you when I was drunk was because I didn't have the stones to do it sober- I remember having that exact thought right before it happened- Catra, I remember, now!"

"What do you remember, exactly?" Catra asked, her voice much softer. Adora wished she would uncross her arms.

“I remember liking it,” She admitted. Catra dropped her gaze, and for the first time, she looked vulnerable.

“I did too,” Catra said. “It just…kind of hurt that that was going to be my life’s consolation prize. One drunk kiss from you that you forgot the next morning.”

“I remember now,” Adora put her hands on Catra’s shoulders. “And I- it doesn’t have to be a consolation prize.”

“What is it, then?” Catra asked.

“Maybe a warm-up?”

Catra finally looked at Adora.

“If that’s what you want, I mean, obviously we don’t have to and I understand if-“

“Adora, you’re so fucking stupid.”

And that was the last thing Adora heard before feeling Catra’s mouth against her own. Kissing Catra was a thousand times better now that she was sober, and now that, if luck was on her side, she would get to kiss her again.

“Well?” Catra asked when they pulled apart. Adora opened her mouth and tried to talk, but instead just started giggling.

“You like me,” She teased. Catra rolled her eyes, but couldn’t stop herself from smiling back.

“You’re such an idiot,” She said before pulling Adora in again.

oOo

Adora wasn't backstage when Glimmer ran into the wings for her quick change.

“Dammit, Adora…” she said softly, pulling off her blouse and looking around the darkened backstage, trying not to panic.

“Glimmer?”

Glimmer whirled around and saw Bow standing behind her, holding her unzipped ballgown the same way Adora was supposed to.

“Where’s Adora?” She whispered.

“She sent me here to help you get changed,” he said.

“But-“ The dance break was halfway over and she could see the plywood carriage ready to come onstage from stage right. “Oh, now’s not the time,” She said, shimmying out of her skirt and stepping into her costume. “Zip me up, will you?”

Bow, grateful that Glimmer had finally said more than three words to him, complied as she pulled off her bandana.

“Is that everything?” He asked, taking her hand and helping her step into her shoes. She nodded her head, pulling on her white gloves. “Wait, no, not everything…”

Bow reached into the crumpled folds of her first act costume and pulled out her tiara.

“It must have fallen,” He said, placing it on her head. Glimmer smiled gratefully, but it quickly fell back into an attempted look of indifference.

“Thanks, Bow,” She said, smoothing imaginary wrinkles on her dress. Bow felt his heart sink- how could he go about the rest of the show when something was so clearly bothering her?

“Glimmer, please-“

But the interlude had ended, and Glimmer was back onstage, revealing her beautiful ballgown to the audience. He could hear Perfuma singing the last verse of her song before the lights went down on the first act.

oOo

Kissing Bow in front of a crowd hurt more than kissing him in front of an empty auditorium. It reminded her, once again, that all the love he was showing her was fabricated, only there for the enjoyment of the audience.

Still, despite everything, Glimmer felt herself smiling when the lights went down on the end of opening night and the patrons started cheering, and her smile only grew when the applause grew louder when she and Bow took their final bows before leading the company towards the end of the curtain call. If nothing else, she had offered them a wonderful performance. When she walked offstage, Perfuma took her hand.

"We're supposed to go out to the foyer," She said to her and the rest of the cast. "To take pictures and greet the fans, you know."

"I don't have fans," Glimmer reminded her, following her down the hallway.

"You'd be surprised," Perfuma said.

Perfuma was, of course, correct, but what Glimmer didn't expect was how many children- children who were much younger than

she was, telling her that they enjoyed the show, and she certainly wasn't used to them coming up to her and immediately making conversation. Normally Bow was the one who kids loved- she supposed it was his years of experience caring for his millions of nieces and nephews, who were always climbing on him and vying for his attention.

But still, her lack of experience aside, getting to talk to a slew of little girls, many of whom were dressed in their own little ballgowns, warmed her heart.

"Your tiara is pretty!" One of them said.

"Thank you, so is yours," Glimmer said, kneeling so she wouldn't have to look up at her. "Did you like the show?"

"Yes!" She said. "I made you this!"

The little girl handed Glimmer a bracelet, made with a rainbow of glittering plastic beads.

"It's beautiful," she said. "I love it."

Bow noticed her put her new bracelet on her wrist, his heart swelling with fondness and pride for his best friend. The little girl hugged her tightly after having her mom take a picture "with the princess!" before trotting down the hallway.

"That's lovely," He told her when she stood back up.

"I know, right? Eat your heart out, Tiffany's," She said, admiring her new bracelet. "I might not ever take it off."

"It suits you," He told her. Glimmer smiled, but there was something distinctly fake about her smile, like it cost her extra effort to keep it in place. Before he could ask her what was wrong once again, Perfuma came up to both of them.

"I'm hosting a cast party tonight," She said, beaming. "We'll toast to a beautiful opening night!"

"That sounds great," Glimmer said. The hallway was almost clear now- Sea Hawk was still talking to Mermista, and a few members of Scorpia's extended family were milling around. "I'm going to go get changed."

And she was gone before Bow could say a word.

He sighed, finally realizing exactly how dejected Prince Christopher must have felt when Cinderella left the palace without saying goodbye.

Chapter End Notes

hey besties! I had kinda a rough day today (Seasonal Affective Disorder SUCKS) and I thought I would go ahead

and post a little update for all of you!

1. Glimmer receiving a bracelet from a little one is based on something that happened to my sister when she played Cinderella, and it's adorable, so now Glimmer has a new bracelet.

2. have y'all ever had to have somebody unexpectedly have to help you with a quick change? there is no reason for that interaction to be as physically charged as it is.

3. I've been watching a lot of Drag Race and I think Catra could do a perfect death drop if the mood ever struck her.

ANYWAY, thank you so much for all of your kudos and kind words, please leave kudos and comments if you feel so moved.

Love,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 8

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Perfuma's basement was filled with the sound of laughter and music and cheerful conversation as the cast of *Cinderella* celebrated their successful opening night, and Glimmer was fighting the urge to feel absolutely miserable. Luckily, Frosta seemed content with evaluating every scene that they shared in order to improve their performance tomorrow, which was a welcome distraction.

"I think we should be taking advantage of the unison breathing in the second verse more," She was saying. "I mean, I know we're all already breathing there together, but I think we could be more deliberate, right?"

"Uh-huh, absolutely," Glimmer said, nodding her head.

"Ooh, there's Mermista!" Frosta said. "I've got to ask her to send me pictures we took, I'll be right back!"

Frosta disappeared into the small crowd. Glimmer's anxiety started growing- Perfuma was talking to Bow across the room, Frosta was chatting with Mermista, and Adora hadn't even arrived yet.

The door opened, and Glimmer's anxiety quickly dissipated when she saw Adora at the foot of the staircase.

"Adora!" She said, walking towards her friend. "Oh, thank goodness you're-"

Then she saw Catra behind Adora, and saw their intertwined hands.

"I-" Glimmer stuttered. "I- hi, Catra."

"Hi, Princess," Catra said. Her voice still held its trademark snark, but Catra seemed happier than Glimmer had ever seen her. "I'll let you explain this one, Adora. I'll get you a drink."

Adora watched Catra walk away, a blissful smile on her face.

"Adora," Glimmer said dumbly. "You're holding hands with- what the hell happened?"

"Glimmer, I kissed Catra at Scorpia's party!" She explained. "And I like, just remembered an hour and a half ago! And now we're kissing regularly!"

Glimmer, struggling to wrap her head around Adora's newest development, found her gaze wandering towards Bow, leaning against the basement wall, laughing at something Perfuma had said.

Adora had kissed Catra earlier that night, not long before she had kissed Bow.

But Adora's kiss had been real. She was holding hands with Catra outside of the auditorium, her kiss had lead to something real. Her kiss with Bow had lead to both of them standing at opposite ends of Perfuma's basement.

"Glimmer? Are you okay?"

"I'm- I'm so happy for you, Adora," She said, taking her friend's hands in her own.

"Thanks, Glimmer," She said. "I feel…wow, we have so much to talk about."

"That might take a while," Glimmer said. "Maybe you should go find Catra again."

"You're right," Adora said. "I'll find you in a bit, if that's okay?"

"Don't worry about me," Glimmer told her. "Go be with Catra. But not too much kissing, I hear too much is bad for you."

“That’s not true and you know it,” Adora said before grabbing her cup and leaving.

And Glimmer was standing alone in Perfuma’s basement. In that moment, watching her castmates laughing and enjoying one another while she stood alone, she could not have felt less like a leading lady. She willed herself not to look at Bow, who was having a splendid time without her.

Glimmer put her hand on her skirt pocket, making sure that her phone was still there before walking outside.

oOo

“That’s what people don’t get about belting,” Perfuma told Bow, who was feeling the ridges of his plastic cup. “It’s a stylistic choice, not a voice type. I mean, legit voices can still belt, just like singers who belt can sound legit.”

Bow nodded his head. He had a feeling that he wasn’t the first person Perfuma had stood on this soapbox in front of.

“But anyway,” She said. “We should probably do our opening night toast before people start leaving- where is Glimmer?”

“I’m not the person to ask,” He said, but still looked around the room for her. The last time he had seen Glimmer, she was talking to Adora (who appeared to be holding onto Catra’s hand? That was a story he was *very* excited to hear), but he hadn’t since her since.

“Is everything- you know, alright between you two?” Perfuma asked delicately.

“I don’t know,” He said honestly. “She’s just been weird today and she won’t- she won’t talk to me about it.”

“Maybe she was nervous about opening night,” Perfuma supplied.

“But she didn’t talk to me after the show, either,” He said. “And Glimmer’s never like this, she’s…she always talks to me.”

Perfuma put her hand on Bow’s shoulder. “You know you mean the world to her, don’t you?”

He shrugged.

“Oh, don’t be like that,” Perfuma rolled her eyes. “I’m sure that Glimmer will tell you what’s going on as soon as you two have the chance to talk things over alone. I mean, you did just have a really busy day.”

Bow furrowed his brow.

"Go see if you can find her," Perfuma said. "Your lover's quarrel notwithstanding, our leading lady needs to be present if we're doing a toast."

"Lover's quarrel?" He asked.

"Go find her," Perfuma said smoothly. "I'll see if she's in the bathroom."

Bow surveyed the basement one more time before stepping outside into the cold night air.

Surely enough, Glimmer was standing in Perfuma's garden, her arms crossed over her chest.

"Hey," Bow said, walking to her. "Are you alright?"

"Yeah," She said, trying to sound casual through her chattering teeth. Damn Autumn. "I just wanted some air."

"You're shivering," He observed. "Here, take my-"

“I don’t need your sweater, Bow, I’m fine.”

But Bow had already shrugged off his cardigan and placed it around her shoulders. Glimmer almost protested, but his jacket was warm and the night was cold, and maybe convincing him to leave her alone would be easier if her teeth weren’t chattering.

“Better?” He asked.

“Much better,” She admitted. “Thanks, Bow.”

“You’re welcome,” he said.

“You know it makes no sense that you’re wearing a sweater with a crop top, right?” She asked.

“That's a little rich coming from the girl wearing said sweater right now."

“Touché,” she admitted.

There was silence between them for a moment. Bow couldn’t remember the last time he and Glimmer had been voluntarily silent- over the last month especially, they were always running

lines or talking through their acting choices or singing to and with one another.

But here she was, not talking to him. Not even looking at him.

"You did really well tonight," He said. "My dads texted me and said that it's the best they've ever heard you sing."

"That's a pretty low bar," She said. "But still sweet of them."

"Glimmer, is something wrong?"

Apparently it wasn't enough for her to simply not look at him, because she turned her face away from his, showing him her back.

"Glimmer," He said, his voice almost stern. "Look, you can't tell me that something isn't bothering you, because you've been acting weird all day and you barely even looked at me backstage, and if you can't tell me what's wrong, then I can't fix it, I- Glimmer?"

Glimmer's shoulders were shaking.

Glimmer was crying.

“Hey,” He said, putting his hand on her shoulder. “Glimmer, what’s wrong? Please tell me what’s wrong. At least turn to face me.”

Glimmer turned towards him, keeping her gaze fixed on the ground.

“It’s stupid,” She said.

“If it’s making you cry, it’s not stupid,” He said. Glimmer let out a shaky sob.

“I just- I just wish you thought I was pretty,” Glimmer said, roughly wiping her eyes on her sleeve.

“What?” Bow asked. “Glimmer, why would you think that- I don’t understand.”

“I heard you talking to Perfuma before final dress,” She explained, her tears falling fast and thick. “And you said that I’m not exactly who you’d expect to play Cinderella, and…”

Bow remembered his conversation with Perfuma and sighed, finally understanding.

“Glimmer, I was talking about your number, how she sings about how mild and meek she is, and- well, Glimmer, come on. You aren’t either of those things- that’s what we were talking about.”

He said. “Did you think that that meant that I didn’t think you were pretty?”

Glimmer nodded her head.

“But you know that’s not true,” Bow said, putting his hands on her shoulders. “You’re beautiful, Glimmer. You’re the most beautiful girl I know.”

“I’m only beautiful because you care about me,” She said, sniffing. Bow put his hand to her face, wiping away her tears with a stroke of his thumb.

“Maybe so,” He said. “But I do think you’re beautiful. I know you’re beautiful.”

Glimmer tried to smile, but couldn’t. His heart fell even further down his chest.

“You look so sad,” He said softly. *Your eyes,* he remembered Prince Charles telling Ella. *Your sad, rebellious eyes.*

“I am sad,” She said honestly.

“Can you tell me why?”

Glimmer took another deep breath- she was crying again. The sound itself was enough to break Bow's heart.

"I didn't get to kiss you," She finally said.

Bow raised his eyebrows. Of all the things she could have said, he was certainly not expecting that.

"Like, onstage?"

"I mean…" She shrugged her shoulders. "I did get to kiss you, but it wasn't real, and I wanted…it's so stupid, but I wanted…"

Glimmer's words collapsed into sobs. Bow let her cry for a moment, weighing his words carefully.

"Look at me, Glimmer," He said softly. "Please look at me."

She reluctantly raised her head. He put his hand underneath her chin and gently lifted her face towards his- she had to stand on her tiptoes to reach him.

He wasn't sure how many years he had been wondering how Glimmer's lips would feel pressed against his- practically, he figured that she would probably taste like vanilla or coffee or

cinnamon gum, and right now, he could taste salt from her tears on her soft, parted lips. But as soon as he kissed her, he knew that he wanted to do so again. He wanted to kiss his best friend.

Prince Christopher had fallen in love with Cinderella within ten minutes. He fell in love with Glimmer over the course of over ten years, over many dances and many songs and long nights, over road trips and study sessions and any holiday he could name, and he refused to believe that that was any worse than love at first sight.

When they pulled apart, Glimmer's eyes were wider than he had ever seen them. She was still standing on her toes.

"That was…" She whispered, their gazes locked together. "Bow, I really, really liked that. Did you mean to do that?"

"I did," He told her, taking her hands in his.

"Can we maybe do it again?" She asked. He smiled.

"Of course," He said. "Again and again and again."

Chapter End Notes

I'll just leave this here

please leave comments and kudos if you feel so moved, y'all are the greatest

Love,
Somebody's Muse

Chapter 9

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

GLIMMER: do you have the tickets?

ADORA: I have mine and Catra's. Bow should have yours

GLIMMER: ok ok, we'll see you there

"Glimmer! Your date is here!"

Glimmer blushed and stuffed her phone in her pocket, resisting the urge to run down the stairs into the foyer where Bow was waiting for her.

"Hi," She said almost shyly.

"Hi yourself," Bow said back.

"Uh, Glimmer, darling," Angella said. Glimmer turned to face her mom.

“Yes?” She asked.

“I’d like you home by eleven, please,” She said.

“Yes ma’am,” Bow said before Glimmer could respond. “I’ll have her home safe and sound.”

Angella gave Bow and approving smile and shooed them out the door.

“What was that about?” She asked, taking Bow’s hand as they walked down her driveway. “‘I’ll have her home safe and sound, *ma’am*.’”

“Well, someone has to.”

“There’s nothing wrong with it, of course, it's just…new.”

“Well, I’m your boyfriend now,” Bow said, opening the passenger side car door. “There are lots of new things.”

“I guess there are,” She said, watching Bow climb into the driver’s seat.

Bow put his keys in the station wagon ignition. Once the car started, he looked over at her and smiled.

"You look so pretty," Bow said, looking at her like she was the most beautiful thing he had ever seen. Glimmer smiled- Bow had called her pretty, or beautiful, or lovely more in the last week than he had during their entire previous lives.

"You look so pretty," She said back, putting her hands on the lapels of his jacket and gently pulling him towards her.

Would she ever get used to kissing Bow? Would her heart ever stop fluttering when their lips met?

She pushed her chin forward, deepening their kiss and reaching her arms around Bow's neck. If there hadn't been a center console between them, she would have been in his lap.

"We're going to be late," He warned her. Glimmer stole a sideways glance at the clock and gave her boyfriend one more quick peck.

"Of course, you're right," She said. "And we shouldn't keep Catra and Adora waiting. You do have our tickets, don't you?"

Bow handed her two pieces of card stock with the time and location of the opening night performance of The Magic Flute.

“Wow, good seats,” Glimmer said.

“Perfuma managed to pull some strings,” Bow said, reaching over and taking ahold of Glimmer’s free hand. “We ran into her at the coffeehouse yesterday. She was very surprised that Adora had never been to the opera.”

“Really? That’s hardly surprising,” Glimmer said. “Adora didn’t know what the Magic Flute was until a few months ago.”

“Oh, right,” Bow said. "She texted the group chat. I totally forgot about that.” He smiled. "I guess that's the day it all started, isn’t it?"

Glimmer blushed and turned into the parking lot. “I guess it is.”

Bow parked the car, then leaned forward and kissed her nose. “C’mon, let’s not keep our friends waiting.”

By the time Glimmer had grabbed her bag and stolen a tiny glance in the mirror, Bow had reached her side of the car and opened the door for her.

“You know you don't have to do that, right?" She asked.

“I like doing it," Bow said simply.

“Well, I can’t argue with that,” She said, letting him hold the opera house doors open for her. Adora and Catra were standing in the lobby, holding hands and already bickering.

“No, Hadestown isn't an opera because there's no dialogue, Perfuma said there’s dialogue in this one-"

“So why not just let the whole thing be dialogue?” Catra asked. Even while they were fighting, they couldn't keep their disbelieving grins off of their faces. If anyone was more overjoyed at the events of Cinderella’s opening night, it would have to be Catra and Adora.

“Hi, you two,” Glimmer said. “Please don’t fight in the opera house, you’ll embarrass us in front of high society.”

“Don’t talk about high society, I worked on a catwalk.” Catra informed Glimmer.

“You hid from Entrapta on a catwalk,” Adora reminded her.

“Anyway, should we go inside?” Bow asked, cutting through the fond bickering. “Perfuma won’t be happy if we're late.”

The four of them walked down the theatre aisles to their seats- Perfuma had managed to get them seats towards the front of the house.

"Alright, we're in the row ahead of you two," Adora said, looking at her ticket. She took ahold of Catra's hand. "We'll see you at intermission."

Glimmer followed Bow down the row of seats and sat down beside him.

"Oh, they're doing a holiday cabaret," He said, looking through the playbill. "We should ask if Perfuma is in that, we should go!"

Glimmer smiled. Bow was planning future dates for them because he was her boyfriend.

Her heart swelled with joy, and she reached out and squeezed his hand. He set the playbill down and looked at her.

"Is something wrong?" He asked. Her smile grew as she shook her head.

"I'm just…I'm just happy things turned out the way they did," She said, leaning her head against his shoulder. Bow kissed her forehead.

“I am too," He said. The house lights dimmed and the orchestra started tuning up. The show began.

Bow never let go of her hand.

Chapter End Notes

hi friends!

here is a little epilogue for your reading pleasure. I love all of you, thank you for reading my fun little fic. This is the beginning of a series, so please expect more from this universe.

please leave kudos and comments if you feel so moved, as always.

Love,
Somebody's Muse

End Notes

Hello friends! Here we are after roughly *checks watch* eight months of not posting a single thing. I missed you all very much. A few things:

1. Rodgers and Hammerstein's Cinderella is one of my favorite musicals and is definitely worth checking out if you feel so compelled- I'm pretty sure that the made-for-TV movie (starring Whitney Houston and 90's icon Brandi, it's truly a work of art) is on Disney+ for your viewing pleasure. It's not necessary to understand the fic, but it might help as we continue on this fun little musical journey together. I have certainly been revisiting it throughout the writing process.

2. My past as an insufferable theatre kid is going to shine through pretty much constantly throughout the course of this fic, hence the detailed audition process and the musical jargon. I apologize in advance, and I am very interested in hearing about any experiences that any of you have had with musicals.

Anyway, thank you thank you thank you for reading this first chapter, I promise to have more for you in the very near future. Please, please, please leave comments and kudos to tell me what you think!

All my love,

Somebody's Muse

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!